PROJECT TITLE

Empowering Young Farmers to Coordinate Agrifood Transformations through Engaged Research Infrastructures and Agroecological Living Labs

TOPIC

Topic 2: Transform value chains, businesses and policies to facilitate the transition to agroecology

SUBTOPIC

2.2: Coordination among actors, social innovations and policies to enhance the agroecological transition

PROJECT DURATION	TOTAL REQUESTED FUNDING	TOTAL COSTS
36 Months (02 / 2026 to 01 / 2029)	1451000 €	1830000 €

ADDITIONAL FIELDS

Herewith I confirm that, to the best of my knowledge, the proposal does not overlap, but rather is complementary with ongoing or completed projects funded by other instruments, programmes or projects	yes

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KEYWORDS

Supplementary keywords	young farmers, governance, agrifood transformations, Agroecological Living Labs (AELLs), Integrated European Long-Term Ecosystem critical zone and socio-ecological Research (eLTER RI)

PROJECT SUMMARY

EMPOWERALL addresses the critical role of youth in agroecological transitions, recognizing their capacity for innovation and long-term commitment to transforming agrifood systems. Despite their potential, young farmers face systemic barriers—political, social, economic, and environmental—that limit their leadership in resilient agriculture. EMPOWERALL's goal is to create enabling conditions for young farmers to drive agrifood systems transformation through transdisciplinary, multi-actor Agroecology Living Labs (AELLs).

Starting with four AELLs in Romania, Slovakia, France and Spain, the project will co-design, test, and refine good practices, inclusive governance mechanisms, and agroecological innovations, including social innovations and business models rooted in agroecological principles. EMPOWERALL integrates diverse perspectives to shape action-oriented policies grounded in local realities. The project strengthens its scientific foundation and connects agroecological solutions to long-term observation and research, through a close collaboration with the Agroecology Partnership, and with the Integrated European Long-Term Ecosystem, Critical Zone and Socio-Ecological Research Infrastructure (eLTER RI).

EMPOWERALL adopts a user-centred Living Lab approach to foster collaboration among young farmers, scientists, policymakers, and local communities and consumers. Each AELL is a real-life experimental setting where participants co-create, test, and evaluate technological, social, nature-based and governance innovations. Using transdisciplinary action research, and experimental and place-based approach, AELLs identify local challenges and co-develop context-specific solutions, combining systems and futures-thinking tools to design sustainable transition pathways.

Co-creation and knowledge exchange between farmers, scientists, and advisors are central to EMPOWERALL's innovations, which are validated through iterative learning cycles. Governance within AELLs is built around multi-actor collaboration frameworks, ensuring fair participation and decision-making. Youth Advisory Councils in each AELL formalize youth involvement in governance and policy discussions, providing a platform for sustained engagement and leadership. EMPOWERALL is designed to deliver lasting change by empowering young farmers as leaders of agroecological transitions. The project promotes youth-led innovation and enhances the visibility of young farmers in agrifood governance. By linking AELLs to eLTER's long-term data and monitoring systems, EMPOWERALL ensures that agroecological practices are evidence-based and scalable.

In the short term, EMPOWERALL will create structured spaces for knowledge exchange and co-production, and participatory decision making, leading to the adoption of sustainable practices that enhance biodiversity, soil health, and climate mitigation and resilience. In the medium and long term, it will strengthen governance mechanisms and stakeholder networks, fostering systemic change in agrifood systems. EMPOWERALL's transnational approach will produce actionable tools and frameworks, ensuring that agroecology becomes a viable career path for the next generation of European farmers.

DESCRIPTION OF WORK

EXCELLENCE

Objectives: Youth play a crucial role in agroecological transitions, bringing innovation, resilience, and long-term commitment to food systems transformation. However, their participation is often hindered by a complex network of systemic barriers – political, social, economic, and environmental – that limit their capacity to lead change.

The overall goal of EMPOWERALL is to empower young farmers and their relevant network of stakeholders to become central actors in driving agroecological transformation across Europe by equipping them with practical tools, supportive networks, and inclusive governance structures, built around Agroecology Living Labs (AELLs). Starting with four AELLs in Romania, Slovakia, France and Spain, EMPOWERALL will create collaborative spaces to reflect about farm succession challenges, co-design, test, share, and refine best practices, inclusive

governance mechanisms, social innovations and sustainable business models based on agroecological principles. By integrating diverse voices and grounding solutions, these processes will help shape policies that are inclusive, action-oriented, and rooted in local realities (Fig.1).



Our vision is to build and sustain a growing network of AELLs that leverages the current design of eLTER RI and its network of LTSER Platforms. A core goal of eLTER RI is to conduct transdisciplinary research, enhance cooperation, provide scientific support, and drive coordinated actions for addressing 'real-world' social-ecological challenges and transformations at multiple scales, from local to continental. EMPOWERALL will inform this goal by demonstrating how place-based agroecological solutions can be connected to long-term observation systems and scaled through the LTSER network..

To achieve this, EMPOWERALL pursues three specific objectives:

SO1: Assess the potential of AELLs in overcoming lock-ins and undesirable trajectories in European agrifood systems.

SO2: Explore potential pathways to engage young actors in AELLs to drive and scale agroecological innovations.

SO3: Enhance knowledge generation to inform policy mixes for agroecological transitions, leveraging eLTER RI to foster policy learning and support AELLs.

State of the art: Agrifood systems are both drivers of and powerful levers for addressing sustainability challenges such as ecological degradation, climate change, socioeconomic instability, social inequalities, and food insecurity (1,2,3,4,5). This underscores the critical need for food systems sustainable transformations worldwide (6,7,8). In Europe, key policies such as the Biodiversity Strategy and Farm to Fork

Strategy set ambitious sustainability goals. The key challenge is how to accelerate and implement them justly (9,10). Agroecology is recognized as a transformative approach for resilient and more secure agrifood systems. It integrates transdisciplinary science, social-ecological concepts, and indigenous and local knowledge to drive collective, scientifically grounded, and social legitimate actions for sustainability, justice, climate resilience, and long-term productivity (11,12,13,14).

Farm succession provides a window of opportunity for agroecological transitions. However, systemic barriers hinder young farmers' engagement in these transitions, including limited resource access (15), economic constraints (16), and societal perceptions (17). Systems thinking is essential to uncover these interlinked factors, revealing lock-ins and levers for transformation (20, 21) which can guide informed policies and foster flexible, resilient solutions (22). Participatory Action Research and Living Lab frameworks foster collaboration between traditional and modern practices, enabling innovation through partnerships with educational institutions, local governments, and NGOs (18,19).

By linking the AELLs to eLTER's long-term biophysical and social-ecological observation system, EMPOWERALL enhances the project's capacity for evidence-based monitoring, comparative studies, and best practices across diverse settings. The project will support sustainable agrifood systems beyond its current governance structure, making farmers, local communities and consumers, and decision-makers central to the data-driven monitoring feedback process, supported through eLTER's global research collaborations.

Concept and approach: EMPOWERALL adopts a transdisciplinary action research methodology to establish and consolidate multi-actor processes i.e. AELLs, within LTSER Platforms (Fig.2).

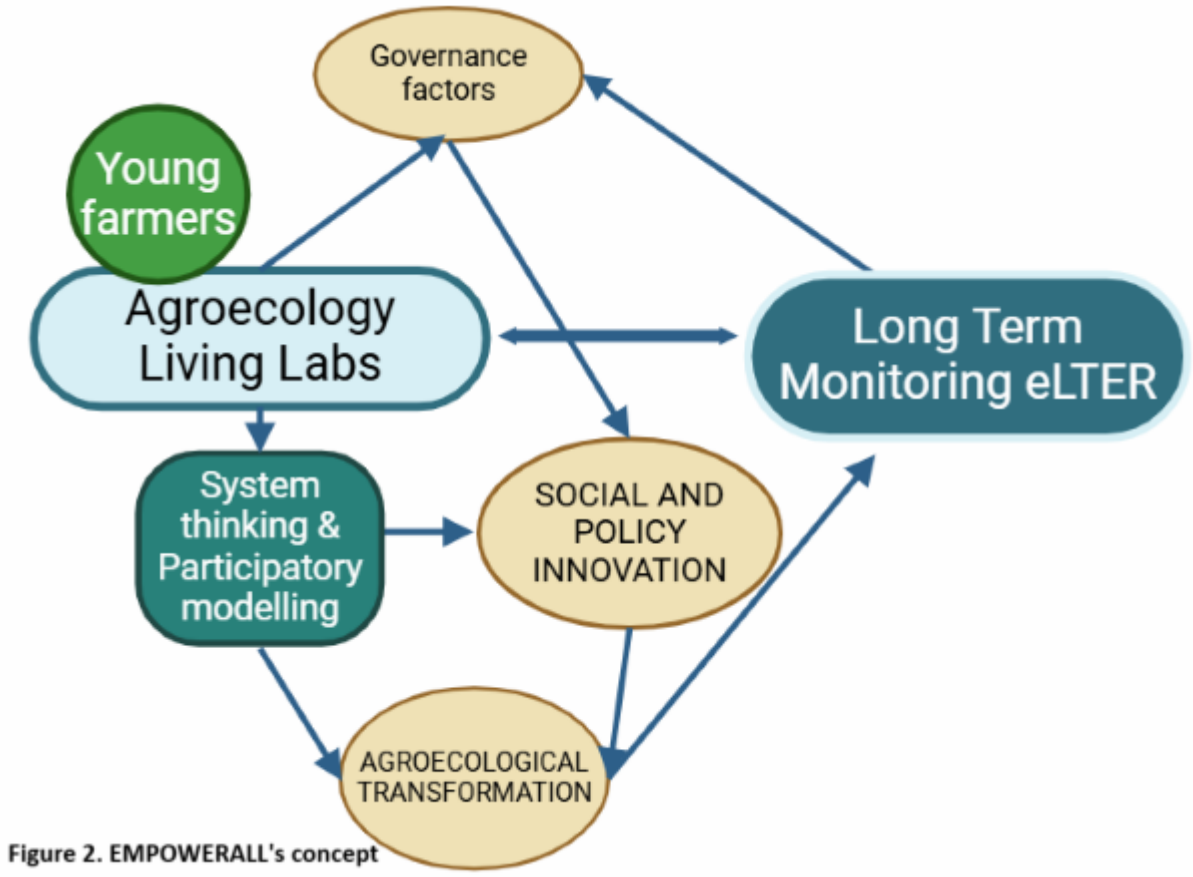


Figure 2. EMPOWERALL's concept

EMPOWERALL addresses three interrelated challenges hindering the agroecological transition. 1) Social and political structures create lock-ins that limit transformative change - understanding them is essential for more inclusive and adaptive governance. 2) Rural youth face structural barriers that constrain their agency and contributions, such as challenges related to knowledge transmission, farm succession, and gender dynamics. 3) Existing policy frameworks often fail to address systemic lock-ins. To enable transformation, policies must ensure coherence across economic, environmental, and social domains.

To tackle these challenges, EMPOWERALL engages young farmers and other stakeholders across the four AELLs (Fig.2) to identify and analyse key variables influencing agrifood transformations. The project leverages a unified Participatory Systems Modelling framework integrating Causal Loop Diagrams (CLDs) as a common approach across the four project's AELLs, incorporating LTSER state-of-the-art modelling outputs and results to refine the CLDs. This harmonized approach enables comparative insights while adapting to the diverse social-ecological contexts represented by the LTSER Platforms and, by default, by the AELLs to be created. Aligned with the call's emphasis on co-creation and multi-actor engagement, this approach ensures findings translate into practical, scalable solutions.

Ambition: EMPOWERALL seeks to redefine youth as key agents of agroecological transitions by addressing structural barriers to their leadership in sustainability initiatives. It will generate new insights into AELLs as catalysts for agrifood system transformations, providing empirical evidence on how governance structures and collective action drive sustainable innovations.

EMPOWERALL will produce a framework that brings together data and tools for developing transdisciplinary approaches with young farmers to empower them for agrifood transformations. This framework will be enriched by eLTER RI experience in transdisciplinary and sustainability transformations research within the LTSER Platforms. EMPOWERALL will establish a network of AELLs, promoting knowledge exchange and scalable solutions towards inclusivity, innovation and sustainability in agrifood systems. It will also provide actionable policy recommendations, embedding governance mechanisms into long-term monitoring frameworks.

Added value for transnational research and innovation: EMPOWERALL's transnational research approach strengthens European collaboration by integrating diverse knowledge systems -scientific and local- to co-create innovative governance solutions for agrifood transformations. By embedding research within AELLs, it will develop actionable tools and frameworks for scaling agroecological innovations across Europe.

A key contribution lies in the integration of social, environmental, and economic dimensions to ensure that agroecological transitions are technically feasible, socially just and politically viable. This systemic perspective will also advance eLTER RI, expanding sustainability assessments to include governance and social structures. Finally, by fostering multi-actor engagement -farmers, policymakers, businesses, and civil society- EMPOWERALL creates a collaborative ecosystem that enhances adoption and scalability of agroecology.

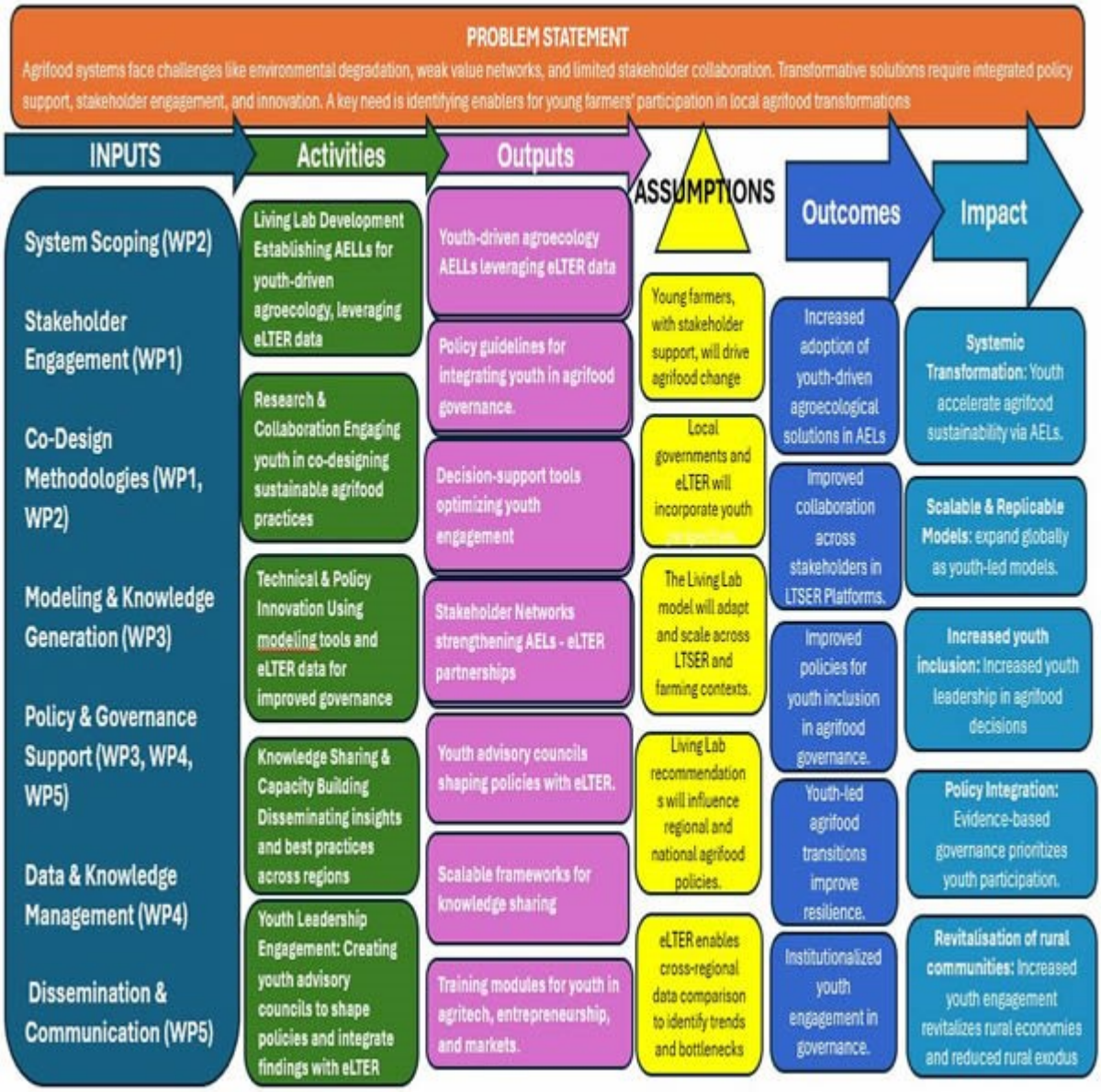
IMPACT

Relevance: EMPOWERALL transforms the role of youth in agrifood systems by addressing systemic barriers i.e. limited access to resources including access to land, knowledge, negative perceptions of agriculture, and socio-economic and institutional challenges. These lock-ins, compounded by environmental uncertainties e.g. climate change, biodiversity loss, and soil degradation, hinder young farmers' engagement in sustainable farming practices. By leveraging AELLs within LTSER Platforms, the project provides support, tools, and networks necessary to empower young farmers into leading agroecological transformations across European landscapes. The Strategic Dialogue on the Future of EU Agriculture (23) envisions the European agriculture and agri-food sectors as cultivators of vibrant rural areas characterized by a bottom-up approach to rural policy, a sense of empowered self-responsibility, and a small-scale diversified landscape with high ecological and touristic value. A key aspect of this vision is the empowerment of rural youth whose active participation has been recognized as essential for slowing rural exodus and ensuring agricultural sustainability. Young generations aspire to contribute through long-term investments that yield mid-term returns, making them key drivers of agricultural sustainability. As a result, ensuring their participation in policymaking and governance has become a guiding political principle. To achieve this, multi-level policymaking must build a consistent and efficient support system for young farmers, including targeted income support through the Common Agricultural Policy (CAP) to prevent farm abandonment and ensure fair income for young farmers and smallholders (23).

Expected impacts (Fig.3): In the short-term EMPOWERALL fosters youth led innovation through co-design of agroecological solutions, leading to the adoption and upscaling of sustainable farming practices that enhance biodiversity, soil health, and climate resilience. The establishment of four AELLs in Romania, Slovakia, France and Spain, creates a diverse and structured space for youth-led innovation, where young farmers engage in knowledge exchange, capacity building, and participatory decision-making. Through policy dialogues and multi-actor collaboration, the project strengthens the visibility and leadership of young farmers, ensuring that their contributions are recognized and supported within agrifood policy frameworks. In the medium term, EMPOWERALL scales youth-driven agroecological innovations across multiple LTSER Platforms. The project enhances governance mechanisms that support young farmers by institutionalizing participatory research methodologies and embedding youth-focused policy recommendations into regional and national frameworks. Strengthened stakeholder networks, including advisory services, policymakers, and research institutions, provide sustained mentorship and financial access pathways, ensuring that young farmers can scale agroecological innovations beyond pilot Living Labs. The long-term impact of EMPOWERALL lies in its ability to catalyse a systemic shift towards youth-led resilient agrifood systems. Through scalable and replicable Living Lab models, young farmers gain long-term support networks, making agroecology a viable and attractive career path. By embedding agroecological transition strategies within governance and market structures, EMPOWERALL fosters a generational shift towards sustainability-driven agrifood systems. EMPOWERALL will contribute to building a supportive ecosystem—anchored in the LTSER network—that makes agroecology a viable and attractive career path. Farmers will be integrated into a growing European network of Agroecological Living Labs, gaining visibility, recognition, and access to evidence-based tools, business models, and policy frameworks that reinforce their role as agents of sustainability in agrifood systems

Measures to maximize impact: To maximize its impact, EMPOWERALL adopts a co-creation approach, ensuring that young farmers are active participants in policy dialogues, decision-making, and innovation processes. The project integrates advanced environmental modelling tools and data from eLTER RI combined with systemic analysis of levers and lock-ins, to develop decision-support frameworks for agrifood governance. A key strategy is the promotion of youth voices to inform governance frameworks and agrifood policy design. Additionally, EMPOWERALL will seek to inform EU initiatives, by promoting the further inclusion of the project's AELLs into the Agroecology Partnership and the ALL-Ready Pilot Network, and collaborating with the nascent Soil Health Living Labs network of the Soil Mission, to align agroecological transitions with European policy goals.

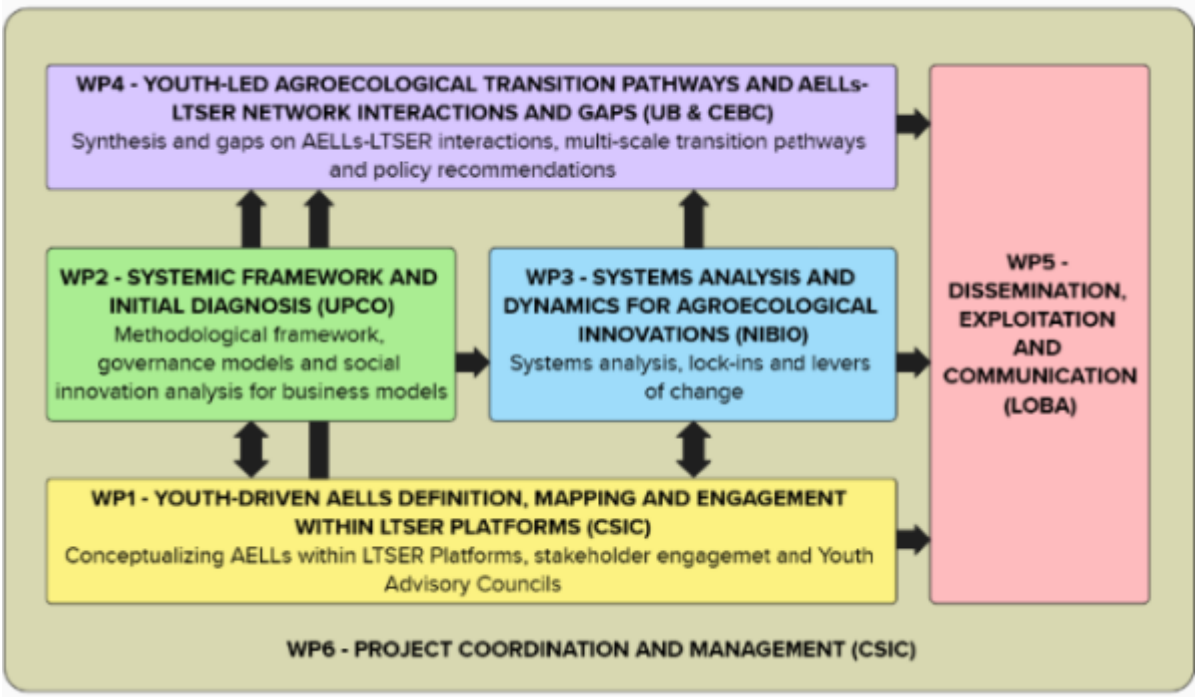
Dissemination and communication activities and exploitation of results: Effective communication, dissemination, and exploitation strategies are crucial for ensuring the visibility, impact, and long-term sustainability of EMPOWERALL's activities and results. These efforts will ensure the project reaches a broad audience, including young farmers, researchers, policymakers, and the general public. The primary goal is to foster a transformative shift towards youth-led agroecology, promoting sustainable practices and innovation through the Agroecology Living Labs (AELLs). For more details see WP5 and the dedicated DEC plan.



IMPLEMENTATION

WP1 will set the foundations for an enhanced understanding of the potential space that the project's AELLs will occupy within each LTSER Platform, including their operational scale and the functional role that they will play. The core target communities will be young farmers and the rural youth overall, considering their current position relative to other farmers and the broader set of regional stakeholders. Synthesis narratives stemming from an exploratory study at the outset of WP1 will serve to inform subsequent activities. The topics included in the data collection methods, will aim at characterising the local agroecological initiatives through key themes such as: (a) their core values and goals around sustainable farming; (b) the sustainable practices and innovations promoted through their services or activities; (c) their core partners and scope of social influence; (d) their approach to young farmers and the rural youth; (e) their geographical scale of operation and the level at which they can influence landscape-level planning, management and policy interventions. These narratives will also provide key information for the analysis of local governance models and social innovations in agroecology (T2.2-3), and constitute a key link for cross-task analysis and synthesis (T4.1), provision of the Transformative Archetypes Catalogue (T3.3). This link will be complemented in a more dynamic way through the development of the project's Agroecological AKIS, whose basis will be established by T1.2. It is to be noted here that, based on previous knowledge from the Consortium's partners, core actors with an overarching role at regional level (e.g., due to their missions or mandates to coordinate other initiatives around similar sustainability goals), were already identified and engaged during full proposal writing. This was done to establish their role as EMPOWERALL local champions that can serve as a direct link with other

stakeholders (especially young farmers) and formalize their participation as Associated Partners linked to their Knowledge Partners (e.g., Puerta de Doñana Farmers Association linked to CSIC, Agrosmart Cluster linked to SCDA).



WP2 Participatory Systems Modelling framework will foster a coherent integration of agroecological principles and multi-level transition steps at the multiple scales at which EMPOWERALL operates, from individuals to farms, regions, and global food systems. Through WP2, EMPOWERALL leverages Causal Loop Diagrams (CLDs) as a common approach across the four project's AELLs, with insights from LTSER state-of-the-art approaches (e.g., Network Analysis, Commons Studies, Socio-Ecological Metabolism). This harmonized approach enables comparative insights while adapting to diverse social-ecological contexts. Aligned with the call's emphasis on co-creation and multi-actor engagement, it ensures findings translate into practical, scalable solutions. Moreover, the development of the framework in Task 2.1 will deliberately align with emerging methodological insights from both academic literature and active projects within the Agroecology Partnership. In particular, synergies will be sought with projects such as Agreco4Cast (systems modelling and forecasting for agroecology), ALLFACTS (agent-based modelling for decision-making), HEAL (landscape-level co-design), LIFT (institutional transitions), and Tapeline (policy design for agroecological living labs). This integration not only strengthens EMPOWERALL's methodological robustness but also contributes to the coherence and complementarity of the Partnership's overall portfolio, avoiding duplication and reinforcing collective impact.

WP3 utilizes Causal Loop Diagrams (CLDs) as a key tool within its systems thinking approach to understand and facilitate the transition to sustainable agricultural systems. CLDs help to visualize the complex interdependencies and feedback loops that contribute to the current state of farming systems, including factors that hinder or "lock in" unsustainable practices. By mapping these relationships, the project aims to identify the key points or "levers" where interventions can be most effective in driving change towards sustainability. This involves understanding how different elements of the system reinforce each other and where positive feedback loops perpetuate desired or undesired outcomes. This recognises that transitions to sustainable farming involve both systemic factors (e.g., policies, market structures) and behavioural factors (e.g., farmer decision-making, consumer choices). CLDs provide a framework to connect these different levels of analysis, showing how individual behaviours are influenced by system structures, and how collective behaviours, in turn, shape the system. This integration allows for a more comprehensive understanding of the challenges and opportunities for change. By mapping out cause-and-effect relationships, CLDs help to articulate the pathways through which governance and business models, and social innovations, elicited in T2.2 and T2.3, can incentivize farmers and decision makers to adopt more sustainable practices.

WP4 will synthesise findings across WP1-3. It will leverage the critical commonalities that both eLTER RI's LTSER Platforms and AELLs share. They both actively contribute to addressing complex socio-ecological challenges by promoting knowledge exchange and continuous learning within their operational settings. While LTSER Platforms provide broad foundational capabilities for transdisciplinary research, AELLs are a more specialised, applied form of research infrastructure that extend the traditional, controlled laboratory setting into dynamic, real-life environments. Through T4.1, EMPOWERALL will assess how AELLs can bridge the gap between rigorous scientific inquiry and practical societal applications. At this stage, the critical input from eLTER RI, Associated Partner in EMPOWERALL, and from Veronika Gaube (BOKU, Austria), who leads the creation of eLTER RI Topic Centre for Synthesis of Actionable Knowledge and has accepted to be one of the project's scientific advisors, will be fundamental. Based on key WP3 results and in insights from iterative synthesis performed through T4.1, T4.2 will provide a structured approach to AELLs to make them capable of fostering complex, multi-faceted change towards more sustainable farming practices at large scale. It will provide a framework to understand complex social-ecological interplays and utilise T3.3's Transformative Archetypes Catalogue to guide the process of moving from current unsustainable practices to desired agroecological

outcomes. The process will be sensitive to place-Based specificities, ensuring that solutions are tailored to the unique environmental, social, and economic conditions of each AELL, while identifying how such solutions can be replicated or adapted to other contexts. Finally, T4.3 will allow for the identification of synergies and trade-offs in policy mixes, to develop comprehensive sets of incentives (e.g., financial support, technical assistance, market access) that are most effective in encouraging farmers to adopt agroecological practices at different stages of their transition.

WP5 is closely connected to all other work packages to ensure that the communication and dissemination strategy evolves in line with the project's progress. Throughout the project, WP5 will collaborate with all work packages, following up on their activities and results to gather key insights, share relevant information with stakeholders, and adapt communication efforts accordingly. This will ensure that actions and messaging remain aligned with the latest findings and developments.

LIVING LAB APPROACH

EMPOWERALL supports youth-driven agroecological models, through social-ecological research and local knowledge, drawing on the know-how of a specialised network (LTSER Platforms, see below) from a flagship European Environmental Research Infrastructure (eLTER RI, see below). A network of ongoing sustainable-farming initiatives linked to the LTSER Platforms will represent the foundations for the creation of four project's Youth-led Agroecological Living Labs (AELLs). These AELLs will serve as experimental hubs, and the wider LTSER network will be used as a backbone for upscaling successful agroecological innovations across Europe. Driven by agroecological principles, AELLs will adopt a multi-actor approach to explore and evaluate technological, nature-based and social innovations in real-life and experimental settings, involving and focusing on the needs of young farmers and rural youth. A key component is the implementation of a place-based transdisciplinary action research approach. Each AELL will identify their local challenges and opportunities related to agroecological transitions. Through targeted workshops, participants will co-create sustainable solutions suitable for their context. Systems-thinking tools will help co-design visions for the future and transition pathways with participants, considering the local biophysical, political-economic and socio-cultural contexts. Co-creation and knowledge sharing between farmers, scientists, advisors and authorities will be core to EMPOWERALL's development of innovations. Iterative learning cycles will validate solutions. Governance within AELLs will be framed around multi-actor collaboration frameworks, ensuring equitable and fair participation and decision making. Each AELL will establish a youth Advisory Council to formalise the youth role in governance and policy discussions. Special attention will be paid to contributing to current efforts for the creation of the European network of AELLs and Research Infrastructures, as outlined by ALL-Ready Pilot Network and the Agroecological Partnership. EMPOWERALL will add value by informing the emerging Agroecological RI, which will provide services and a framework for agroecological transitions, through eLTER RI's historical experience on data and services for broader biophysical and social-ecological research and transformations.

RESPONSE TO ESR

PARTNER DATA

Partner 1 (Consortium Coordinator): CSIC (Spanish National Research Council)

FINANCE COMMENTS

Personnel	109 k€: 1 postdoc, 24 PM; Own contributions: co-PIs, 12 PM
Travel	11.5 k€: Three consortium meetings, 2 people, 3 days, Europe; 11.5 k€: 3 fieldwork and local workshop campaigns at each LTSER Platform/AELL, 2 people, 3 days, Europe
Consumables / Equipment	N/A
Subcontracts	N/A
Other	8.5 k€: Organization of Kick-off Consortium meeting in Valencia or Madrid (TBD)

TEAM MEMBER

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First name	Pablo
Family name	Mendez
Phone number	
Function	Coordinator of WP & Co-PI

TASK(S)

INGENIO will be in charge of the overall coordination of the project, as well as WP1. which consists in "Stakeholders mapping and Living Lab engagement": value network- the creation of Living Labs collaborative system through setting up a stakeholder board to analyze social and economic barriers and potentialities, to improve awareness of stakeholders and to improve communication between them about opportunities for collaboration along the bio-based value chain. It will also participate as a partner in the other WPs.

LITERATURE REFERENCES

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ADDITIONAL FIELDS

Team members description - optional	The INGENIO multidisciplinary team brings scientific knowledge on agroecology and systems modeling (Pablo F. Mendez WP1, WP3), innovation and sustainability transformations (Cristina Chaminade, WP2) as well as transition pathways (WP4). Cristina Chaminade is a Research Professor at INGENIO (CSIC-UPV), Spanish National Research Council. With a robust background in economics (Bachelor's and Ph.D.) and postgraduate studies in ecology and conservation from Harvard University, she works on the intersection of regenerative economics, innovation, and environmental conservation. Her main research questions revolve around the transformation's directionality, geographical scale, and speed. She has extensive experience in managing international and interdisciplinary projects and in primary data collection in various geographies. Pablo F. Mendez is a tenured researcher at INGENIO. He is an environmental social scientist and transdisciplinary action researcher, specialized in policy and institutional analysis combining evolutionary, resilience thinking, power and commons perspectives. His aim is to understand, collaboratively with stakeholders, how to organize collective action towards equitable and sustainable outcomes in three realms: coastal wetlands, agricultural landscapes and the soil commons. He is currently leading the development of the policy analysis function and protocols for the observation of social-ecological governance in LTSER Platforms in Pillar I H2020 eLTER PLUS Project (eLTER RI). Also, he is in charge of developing governance models, in coordination with business models, for the first cohort of Soil Health Living Labs from the EU Soil Mission in Pillar II Horizon GOV4ALL Project.
Specify the Funder	
Relevance to Funders' programme	
Person-Months	36
Theme(s):	2.2: Coordination among actors, social innovations and policies to enhance the agroecological transition
9-digit Participant Identification Code (PIC)	999991722
Do you agree that we will use your contact data for our internal processes in AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
Are you a Beneficiary of (signatory of the Grant Agreement) the Partnership AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
I hereby confirm that I have not received any confidential information on this call and prior to the launch, which would result in an advantage towards other potential applicants	yes

Partner 2: Norwegian Institute of Bioeconomy Research

FINANCE COMMENTS

Personnel	321 k€: 3 researchers, 19 PM
Travel	29.8 k€: Three consortium meetings, 3 people, 3 days, Europe; 29.8 k€: 3 fieldwork and local workshop campaigns at each LTSER Platform/AELL, 3 people, 3 days, Europe
Consumables / Equipment	N/A
Subcontracts	N/A
Other	30 k€ Costs for knowledge transfer activities. 17 k€ Cost for open publication fees for the whole project

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Phone number	
Function	Advisor

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Function	Research Scientist

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Family name	Stolte
Phone number	
Function	Senior Researcher

TASK(S)

WP leadership, State of the art mapping the Living Labs - Analysis of social innovation processes, governance (power dynamics , value networks) and business models to ease transitions towards agroecological system. Drafting of the methodological framework. Involvement in other activities including DEC activities, compilation of policy briefs and recommendations

LITERATURE REFERENCES

- Bechmann, Marianne; Bøe, Frederik; Eggestad, Hans Olav; Isidorova, Anastasija; Kvernø, Sigrun; Lang, Kathinka; Holten, Roger; Molversmyr, Åge; Ugstad, Hanne
  Jord- og vannovervåking i landbruket (JOVA). Feltrapporter fra programmet i 2022/2023
  NIBIO Rapport (10), 151 (2024)
  https://hdl.handle.net/11250/3170445
- Bøe, Frederik, Jannes Stolte, Loes van Schaik, and Coen Ritsema.
  A pedo-climatic approach towards soil health assessment: Soil texture-specific scoring curves on arable land in Norway
  Soil Use and Management (40), 1 (2024)
  https://doi.org/10.1111/sum.12947
- Ottaviani Aalmo, Giovanna, Beniamino Gioli, Divina Gracia P. Rodriguez, Diana Tuomasjukka, Hai-Ying Liu, Maria Chiara Pastore, Fabio Salbitano, Peter Bogetoft, Arne Sæbø, and Cecil Konijnendijk
  Development of a novel framework for the assessment and improvement of climate adaptation and mitigation actions in Europe

Frontiers in Sustainable Cities (), (2022)
https://doi.org/10.3389/frsc.2022.833098

ADDITIONAL FIELDS

Team members description - optional	Nibio's team brings together expertise in agroecology, governance, sustainability, and participatory research to drive youth-led agrifood transformations. Dr. Giovanna Ottaviani Aalmo brings extensive experience in bioeconomy research, climate adaptation, and agroecological transitions. She has led projects on governance, policy coherence, and social innovation, ensuring young farmers' active role in sustainability pathways. Dr. Jannes Stolte is a senior researcher in soil and water management, focusing on climate adaptation and sustainable land use. His expertise supports the assessment of environmental impacts in Agroecology Living Labs (AELs), particularly in soil health and water interactions. Hanne Ugstad specializes in Jova monitoring and contributes to co-creation processes within AELs, ensuring meaningful collaboration among young farmers, researchers, and policymakers. Dr. María del Pilar Bustamante Liria is an expert in food systems transformation, participatory modeling, and sustainability transitions. She leads scenario analysis, integrating systems thinking to co-design agroecological solutions with youth.
Specify the Funder	Norwegian Research Council
Relevance to Funders' programme	
Person-Months	19
Theme(s):	2.2: Coordination among actors, social innovations and policies to enhance the agroecological transition
9-digit Participant Identification Code (PIC)	999754848
Do you agree that we will use your contact data for our internal processes in AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
Are you a Beneficiary of (signatory of the Grant Agreement) the Partnership AGROECOLOGY?	No
I hereby confirm that I have not received any confidential information on this call and prior to the launch, which would result in an advantage towards other potential applicants	yes

Partner 3: CEBC

FINANCE COMMENTS

Personnel	145 k€: 1 postdoc, 16 PM; 1 researcher, 20 PM
Travel	12 k€: Three consortium meetings, 2 people, 3 days, Europe; fieldwork in LTSER
Consumables / Equipment	N/A
Subcontracts	N/A
Other	21.1 k€ Meeting organisations+restitutions+publicatoin fees

TEAM MEMBER

Title	Dr

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Phone number	
Function	Senior researcher

Title	Dr
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First name	Vincent
Family name	Bretagnolle
Phone number	
Function	Senior Researcher

Title	Mr
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First name	Romain
Family name	Bonnet
Phone number	
Function	Engineer

TASK(S)

CEBC will contribute to EMPORWALL aims. CEBC will especially analyse transition pathways in the 4 sites (task 4.2) and explores through experiments within the Living Lab 2.Sèvres embedded in the LTSER Zone Atelier Plaine & Val de Sèvre, how transmission can be a lever towards agroecological transition.

LITERATURE REFERENCES

- Bretagnolle, V., Berthet, E., Gross, N., ..., Gaba, S.
  Towards sustainable and multifunctional agriculture in farmland landscapes: Lessons from the integrative approach of a French LTSER platform
  Science of the Total Environment (627), 822-834 (2018)
  https://10.1016/j.scitotenv.2018.01.142
- Gaba, S, & Bretagnolle, V.
  Social–ecological experiments to foster agroecological transition
  People and Nature (2), 317-327 (2020)
  https://10.1002/pan3.10078
- Berthet, E., Bretagnolle, V., & Gaba, S.
  Place–based social–ecological research is crucial for designing collective management of ecosystem services
  Ecosystem Services (55), 1-11 (2022)
- Berthet, E., Gaba, S., Bombard, C., Goinard, M., Benvegnu, N., et al..
  Setting–up place–based and transdisciplinary research to foster agrifood system transformation: Insights from the Aliment'Actions project in western France

Frontiers in Sustainable Food Systems (7), 886353 (2023)
https://10.3389/fsufs.2023.886353

ADDITIONAL FIELDS

Team members description - optional	CEBC is an interdisciplinary research team bringing together researchers from the CNRS, INRAE and the University of La Rochelle. The research aims to understand the levers and barriers for the transformation of rural areas into resilient socio-ecosystems that are healthy for all (in the sense of OneHealth). CEBC carries out transdisciplinary research in the LTSER Zone Atelier Plaine & Val de Sèvre, a 450 km² agricultural area that is also a research infrastructure and part of the European eLTER and AGROECOLOGY networks. In 2024, as part of the French PEPR SOLUTION programme, CEBC set up a living lab in the LTSER Zone Atelier Plaine & Val de Sèvre, bringing together farmers and agricultural stakeholders to test, with these stakeholders, nature-based solutions to foster agroecological transition.
Specify the Funder	
Relevance to Funders' programme	
Person-Months	36
Theme(s):	2.2: Coordination among actors, social innovations and policies to enhance the agroecological transition
9-digit Participant Identification Code (PIC)	999997930
Do you agree that we will use your contact data for our internal processes in AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
Are you a Beneficiary of (signatory of the Grant Agreement) the Partnership AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
I hereby confirm that I have not received any confidential information on this call and prior to the launch, which would result in an advantage towards other potential applicants	yes

Partner 4: GLOBAZ, S.A.

FINANCE COMMENTS

Personnel	102.5 k€: project managers, programmers, designers and consultants, 34 PM
Travel	4.5 k€: Three consortium meetings, 1 person, 3 days, Europe
Consumables / Equipment	N/A
Subcontracts	N/A
Other	5.5 k€ of other costs for digital campaings. Video voice overs and music rights.

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Function	Chief Design Officer

Title	Mr
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Function	Video Cinematographer and Audio Engineer

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Function	Web Engineer

TASK(S)

Dissemination and Communication Management:

The management of dissemination and communication for the EMPOWERALL project encompasses a range of tasks aimed at ensuring a strategic, impactful, and EU-compliant approach to engaging stakeholders and promoting project outcomes. This includes the development and implementation of the Communication and Dissemination Plan, which defines key messages, branding strategies, and engagement frameworks, establishing a strong project identity that maximizes visibility and impact.
A key aspect of this work involves overseeing the creation and management of content across multiple platforms, including the project website, social media channels, newsletters, press releases, and multimedia materials. With a focus on audience engagement, this also includes the development of compelling storytelling, infographics, and video content to translate complex project findings into accessible and engaging narratives.
Additionally, the coordination of the consortium's participation and promotion of project events ensures effective dissemination before, during, and after key activities such as workshops, webinars, and conferences.
The impact assessment and reporting of communication efforts is also a core responsibility, involving the regular monitoring of engagement metrics and KPIs to evaluate effectiveness, optimize strategies, and contribute to periodic reports on the project's dissemination success and areas for improvement.

LITERATURE REFERENCES

ADDITIONAL FIELDS

Team members description - optional	
Specify the Funder	
Relevance to Funders' programme	
Person-Months	34
Theme(s):	2.2: Coordination among actors, social innovations and policies to enhance the agroecological transition
9-digit Participant Identification Code (PIC)	983211983
Do you agree that we will use your contact data for our internal processes in AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
Are you a Beneficiary of (signatory of the Grant Agreement) the Partnership AGROECOLOGY?	No
I hereby confirm that I have not received any confidential information on this call and prior to the launch, which would result in an advantage towards other potential applicants	yes

Partner 5: Universidad Pontificia Comillas

FINANCE COMMENTS

Personnel	99 k€: 1 postdoc, 12 PM + 1 predoc, 12 PM; Own contributions: 1 researcher, 8 PM
Travel	10 k€: Three consortium meetings, 2 people, 3 days, Europe; 10 k€: 3 fieldwork and local workshop campaigns at each LTSER Platform/AELL, 2 people, 3 days, Europe
Consumables / Equipment	N/A
Subcontracts	N/A
Other	N/A

TEAM MEMBER

TASK(S)

- Co-development of the methodological framework for the whole project.
- System analysis: Analyses Living Labs dynamics and identify lock- ins and levers for the agroecological transformation, with a focus on youth inclusion in the agroecological discourse in Europe. This will be done for each of the Living Labs through co-creation of Causal Loop Diagrams

LITERATURE REFERENCES

- Meneses-Falcón, C., Rúa-Vieites, A., & Uroz-Olivares, J.
  Exploring the role of Spanish judges in the investigation and prosecution of human trafficking for the purpose of sexual exploitation.
  Criminology & Criminal Justice (22 (4)), 601-617 (2022)
  https://doi.org/10.1177/1748895820984820
- Prieto-Ursúa, M., Charro Baena, B., Caperos J.M., Meneses Falcón, C., Uroz Olivares, J.
  Alcohol consumption in adolescents: The predictive role of drinking motives.
  Psicothema (32(2)), 189-196 (2020)
  10.7334/psicothema2019.263
- Baena, B. C., Meneses, C., Caperos, J. M., Prieto, M., Uroz, J.
  The Role of Religion and Religiosity in Alcohol Consumption in Adolescents in Spain
  Journal of Religion and Health (58(5)), 1477–1487 (2019)
  http://www.jstor.org/stable/45216929

ADDITIONAL FIELDS

Team members description - optional	The Universidad Pontificia Comillas will assemble an interdisciplinary team for this research project under the coordination of the IP, Jorge Uroz. Needed expertise on agroecology and food systems, youth empowerment and participation, systems methods, and food systems analysis will be brought together among the expertise of the researchers and professors within the university. Additionally research capacities will be funded by this project, strengthening even more the reach, quality and impact of the activities that Comillas will develop within this consortium.
Specify the Funder	AGENCIA ESPAÑOLA DE INVESTIGACIÓN
Relevance to Funders' programme	
Person-Months	24
Theme(s):	2.2: Coordination among actors, social innovations and policies to enhance the agroecological transition
9-digit Participant Identification Code (PIC)	999907817
Do you agree that we will use your contact data for our internal processes in AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
Are you a Beneficiary of (signatory of the Grant Agreement) the Partnership AGROECOLOGY?	No
I hereby confirm that I have not received any confidential information on this call and prior to the launch, which would result in an advantage towards other potential applicants	yes

Partner 6: University of Bucharest

FINANCE COMMENTS

Personnel	71.5 k€: 1 researcher, 13 PM
Travel	3 k€: 2 consortium meeting, 2 people, 2 days, Europe; 1.5 k€: fieldwork at LTSER Platform
Consumables / Equipment	N/A
Subcontracts	N/A
Other	4 k€ Meeting organisation

TEAM MEMBER

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Function	

Title	Mr
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First name	Tudor
Family name	Racoviceanu
Phone number	
Function	Researcher

Title	Mr
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First name	Valentin
Family name	Dinu
Phone number	
Function	Researcher

Title	Ms
Email address	
First name	Georgia
Family name	ARHIRE

Phone number	
Function	Researcher

TASK(S)

UB will co-lead with CEBC WP4, which will collaboratively design the transition pathways for each LL, based on the results from the stakeholders mapping (WP1), the diagnosis of social innovation, governance structures, and business models within AELs (WP2), and systems analysis (WP3). The transition pathways will be presented as an European level output with general recommendations for transitioning, linking to LTSER Platforms and more generally to eLTER RI.

LITERATURE REFERENCES

- Maasri, A., Jähnig, S.C., Adamescu, M.C., Adrian, R., Baigun, C., Baird, D.J., et al. (2022)
  A global agenda for advancing freshwater biodiversity research.
  Ecology Letters (25), 255–263 (2022)
  10.1111/ele.13931
- Angelstam, P., Manton, M., Elbakidze, M. Adamescu, M.C et al.
  LTSER platforms as a place-based transdisciplinary research infrastructure: learning landscape approach through evaluation.
  Landscape Ecol (34), 1461–1484 (2019)
  10.1007/s10980-018-0737-6
- J.M. Holzer, C.M. Adamescu, C. Cazacu, R. Díaz-Delgado, J. Dick, P.F. Méndez, L. Santamaría, D.E. Orenstein,
  Evaluating transdisciplinary science to open research-implementation spaces in European social-ecological systems
  Biological Conservation (238), (2019)
  10.1016/j.biocon.2019.108228
- Racoviceanu, T., Cazacu, C., Adamescu, M., Giucă, R., Bucur, M., Fedoriak, M., & Angelstam, P.
  Agricultural Intensification Reduces the Portfolio of Wetland Ecosystem Services: European Danube River Lowlands as a Global Biodiversity Hotspot. ,
  Land (12(3)), 722 (2023)
  10.3390/land12030722

ADDITIONAL FIELDS

Team members description - optional	RCSES is the entity of the University of Bucharest for multi and trans-disciplinary research in systems ecology and sustainability. RCSES teams up with the Department of Systems Ecology and Sustainability in providing top level support for the development and implementation of Sustainability Science. RCSES integrates both basic research related to defining and modeling the structure, dynamics and stability conditions of interrelated terrestrial and aquatic ecosystems and applied research for deeper understanding of interactions within and between socio-ecological systems. RCSES integrates observation systems and curiosity driven research, from the smallest scale of genetic diversity to large-scale and even to whole-Earth System. We work across disciplines and facilitate academic, public, private and voluntary sector partnerships. RCSES has extensive experience in long-term monitoring, analysis and modeling, providing early warnings of change and management solutions for our land-waterscapes. RCSES is leading
Specify the Funder	
Relevance to Funders' programme	
Person-Months	13

Theme(s):	2.2: Coordination among actors, social innovations and policies to enhance the agroecological transition
9-digit Participant Identification Code (PIC)	884562595
Do you agree that we will use your contact data for our internal processes in AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
Are you a Beneficiary of (signatory of the Grant Agreement) the Partnership AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
I hereby confirm that I have not received any confidential information on this call and prior to the launch, which would result in an advantage towards other potential applicants	yes

Partner 7: Agricultural Research and Development Station of Braila

FINANCE COMMENTS

Personnel	71.5 k€: 2PhD students, 30PM
Travel	3 k€: 2 consortium meeting, 2 people, 2 days, Europe
Consumables / Equipment	5.5 k€: consumable for laboratory equipments
Subcontracts	N/A
Other	N/A

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Title	Mr
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Family name	Mihaila
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Function	PhD student, assistant researcher

TASK(S)

SCDA will closely collaborate with UB in the definition of the Romanian AEL in WP4, providing their expertise on requirements for adaptation to climate change and overall resilience, by monitoring crops with sensors, satellites and drones of agricultural and horticultural crops, using cover crops for improving soil fertility, using agroforest curtains, finding new germplasm resources for agricultural and horticultural crops; testing new species and varieties in different countries and pedoclimatic conditions, multiplying the best varieties and preserving in a genebank, biological control of some pests in agricultural and horticultural crops by using their predators, using of natural pollinators in protected spaces, and dissemination of results.

LITERATURE REFERENCES

- Daniela TRIFAN, Emanuela LUNGU, Alin Ionel GHIORGHE, Daniel George ȘERBAN
  The importance of agroforestry curtains for anti-erosion protection and increasing the productivity of agricultural crops
  Scientific Papers. Series A. Agronomy, Vol. LXVII, No. 1, 2024 ISSN 2285-5785; ISSN CD-ROM 2285-5793; ISSN Online 2285-5807; ISSN-L 2285-5785 (LXVII), 909-914 (2024)
  www.agronomyjournal.usamv.ro/pdf/2024/issue_1/Art117.pdf
- TRIFAN Daniela, Emanuela LUNGU, Alin Ionel GHIORGHE, Popescu Nicolae
  Research about adaptation of agricultural technologies for successive crops, in the conditions of current climate changes and desertification phenomena in South-Eastern territory of Romania
  3rd International Conference on Academic Research in Science, Technology and Engineering (ICARSTE) (3), 1-9 (2020)
  https://www.dpublication.com/wp-content/uploads/2020/11/1-3001.pdf
- TRIFAN Daniela, TOADER G., GHIORGHE A.I., LUNGU Emanuela, Enea C.I., Ilie L.
  The importance of succesive or double agricultural crops in South-Estern of Romania, in the climatic change perspective
  Proceedings of the 7th International Conference on Engineering and Natural Sciences (ICENS) (7), 172-180 (2021)
  https://www.icens.eu/sites/default/files/2021_icens_proceedings_v2.pdf
- TRIFAN Daniela
  Global Climate Change, A New Challenge for Adapting Agricultural Technologies and Obtaining Healthy Food.

Proceeding Book 12-13 November 2021 ISBN: 978-605-73858-7-1 (6), 24-28 (2021)
http://iches.idu.edu.tr/wp-content/uploads/2022/01/ICHES-TAM-METIN-KITAPCIGI-2021.pdf

- Daniela TRIFAN, Theodora Andreea TRIFAN, Emanuela LUNGU, Luxiţa RÎŞNOVEANU, Alin Ionel GHIORGHE, Daniel George Şerban Increasing agricultural crops productivity through bioremediation methods of conserving soil and environmental resources Proceedings of International Congress of Health Sciences de la Izmir Democracy University (8), (2023)
https://iches.idu.edu.tr/index. php/invited-speakers/

ADDITIONAL FIELDS

Team members description - optional	The research team within SCDA includes three senior researchers and two assitant researchers and PhD students, who will implement the experiments described in the proposal. They have important connections with farmers in southeastern Romania, for whom they conduct agrochemical studies and offer consultancy in crop technologies. They are also currently implementing 10 national research projects and have research contracts with Romanian and foreign companies, for testing biofertilizers and different varieties and hybrids, as well as testing new species with tolerance to drought conditions, which are increasingly accentuated due to climate change.
Specify the Funder	
Relevance to Funders' programme	
Person-Months	30
Theme(s):	2.2: Coordination among actors, social innovations and policies to enhance the agroecological transition
9-digit Participant Identification Code (PIC)	881149165
Do you agree that we will use your contact data for our internal processes in AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
Are you a Beneficiary of (signatory of the Grant Agreement) the Partnership AGROECOLOGY?	No
I hereby confirm that I have not received any confidential information on this call and prior to the launch, which would result in an advantage towards other potential applicants	yes

Partner 8: Institute of Landscape Ecology

FINANCE COMMENTS

Personnel	45 k€: 1 postdoc, 12 PM; 1 researcher, 24 PM
Travel	13 k€: Three consortium meetings, 3 people 3 days, Europe; 6 k€: fieldwork at LTSER Platform/AELL
Consumables / Equipment	6k€: field computer, office equipment, 2 desktop computers
Subcontracts	N/A
Other	21 k€: Organisation of meetings with farmers and services related to development of living lab, 5k€: publication fees

TEAM MEMBER

Title	Prof

Email address	zita.izakovicova@savba.sk
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Phone number	421 2 3229 3607
Function	

TASK(S)

ILE SAS will contribute to the establishment of an AELL within LTSER Platform in the Trnava region. ILE SAS will be involved in stakeholder mapping (WP1), with a particular emphasis on young farmers, in analysing the current state of AELLs (WP2), and in the analysis and dynamics related to youth-led agroecological innovations (WP3). Additionally, ILE SAS will collaborate on activities within WP4 for the elicitation of transition pathways at multiple scales for the farms involved in Trnava local AELL.

LITERATURE REFERENCES

ADDITIONAL FIELDS

Team members description - optional	Prof. Zita Izakovičová - former director of ILE SAS, Several memberships in Scientific and Professional Organizations Some of the relevant publications: - Izakovičová, Z., Mederly, P., Petrovič, F. (2017). Long-Term Land Use Changes Driven by Urbanisation and Their Environmental Effects (Example of Trnava City, Slovakia). Sustainability. 9. 1553. 10.3390/su9091553. - Dick, J., Orenstein, D. E., Holzer, J. M., Wohner, C., Achard, A. L., Andrews, C., Avriel-Avni, N., Beja, P., Blond, N., Cabello, J., Chen, C., Díaz-Delgado, R., Giannakis, G. V., Gingrich, S., Izakovicova, Z., Krauze, K., Lamouroux, N., Leca, S., Melecis, V., Miklós, K., Van Ryckegem, G. (2018). What is socio-ecological research delivering? A literature survey across 25 international LTSER platforms. The Science of the total environment, 622-623, 1225–1240. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.scitotenv.2017.11.324 - Izakovičová, Z., Miklos, L., Špulerová, J. et al. Data collection for assessment of the natural capital at the regional level: case study of LTSER Trnava region. Environ Sci Eur 36, 65 (2024). https://doi.org/10.1186/s12302-024-00894-w National coordinator of several international projects: (EVALWET, BIOSCENE, SOBIO, ALTER-NET, SENSOR, POINT) Dr. Anrej Raniak Some of the relevant publications: MOYZEOVÁ, M., RANIAK, A.(2021). Demographic analysis and perception of changes in the agricultural landscape of the Nová Vieska municipality. In Ekologické štúdie, 12,1, 47-67. IZAKOVIČOVÁ, Z., - MIKLÓS, L., - MIKLÓSOVÁ, V., - RANIAK, A. (2020). Intgrated approach to the management of the landscape for the implementation of the Danube strategy. Ekológia (Bratislava) : 39, 4, 357-379.https://doi.org/10.2478/eko-2020-0029 Izakovičová, Z., Miklos, L., Špulerová, J. et al. Data collection for assessment of the natural capital at the regional level: case study of LTSER Trnava region. Environ Sci Eur 36, 65 (2024). https://doi.org/10.1186/s12302-024-00894-w
Specify the Funder	Slovak Academy of Sciences
Relevance to Funders' programme	
Person-Months	36

Theme(s):	2.2: Coordination among actors, social innovations and policies to enhance the agroecological transition
9-digit Participant Identification Code (PIC)	999903937
Do you agree that we will use your contact data for our internal processes in AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
Are you a Beneficiary of (signatory of the Grant Agreement) the Partnership AGROECOLOGY?	No
I hereby confirm that I have not received any confidential information on this call and prior to the launch, which would result in an advantage towards other potential applicants	yes

Partner 9: GODS

FINANCE COMMENTS

Personnel	36 k€ + Own contributions: 1 project manager, 12 PM
Travel	5.6 k€: meeting attendance as required and fieldwork in LTSER
Consumables / Equipment	N/A
Subcontracts	N/A
Other	5.6 k€ Meetings organisation

TEAM MEMBER

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Function	Animatrice

Title	Ms
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Family name	Pellon
Phone number	
Function	Administratrice

Title	Mr
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Family name	Debenest
Phone number	
Function	Animateur Mesures Agri-Environnementales

TASK(S)

Partner GODS will provide local knowledge and support to CEBC in the organisation and execution of T4.2 activities.

LITERATURE REFERENCES

ADDITIONAL FIELDS

Team members description - optional	
Specify the Funder	
Relevance to Funders' programme	
Person-Months	12
Theme(s):	2.2: Coordination among actors, social innovations and policies to enhance the agroecological transition
9-digit Participant Identification Code (PIC)	1
Do you agree that we will use your contact data for our internal processes in AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
Are you a Beneficiary of (signatory of the Grant Agreement) the Partnership AGROECOLOGY?	No
I hereby confirm that I have not received any confidential information on this call and prior to the launch, which would result in an advantage towards other potential applicants	yes

Partner 10: SAS DLR

FINANCE COMMENTS

Personnel	36 k€ + Own contributions: 1 project manager, 12 PM
Travel	2.25 k€: meeting attendance as required and fieldwork in LTSER
Consumables / Equipment	N/A
Subcontracts	N/A
Other	2.2 k€ Meetings organisation

TEAM MEMBER

Title	Mr
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Family name	DE LA ROCHEBROCHARD
Phone number	0676349214
Function	CEO

TASK(S)

Partner SAS DLR will provide local knowledge and support to CEBC in the organisation and execution of T4.2 activities.

LITERATURE REFERENCES

ADDITIONAL FIELDS

Team members description - optional	
Specify the Funder	
Relevance to Funders' programme	
Person-Months	12
Theme(s):	2.2: Coordination among actors, social innovations and policies to enhance the agroecological transition
9-digit Participant Identification Code (PIC)	0001
Do you agree that we will use your contact data for our internal processes in AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
Are you a Beneficiary of (signatory of the Grant Agreement) the Partnership AGROECOLOGY?	No
I hereby confirm that I have not received any confidential information on this call and prior to the launch, which would result in an advantage towards other potential applicants	yes

Partner 11: Asociación de Agricultores Puerta de Doñana

FINANCE COMMENTS

Personnel	9k€ Own contributions: 1 project manager, 3 PM
Travel	N/A
Consumables / Equipment	N/A
Subcontracts	N/A

Other	N/A

TEAM MEMBER

TASK(S)

The role of Asociación de Agricultores Puerta de Doñana will be to participate as key stakeholder in the project's initial set of in-depth interviews (T1.1) to help designing the involvement of young farners and characterising the local sustainable farming activities. Asociación de Agricultores Puerta de Doñana will also be fundamental for the mapping and engaging with the broader set of relevant stakeholders (T1.2) and taking a role as EMPOWERALL local champion that can serve as a direct link with other stakeholders (especially young farmers), getting their feedback on the Work Plan to adjust critical activities to local needs. Asociación de Agricultores Puerta de Doñana contribution will also be necessary in all the participatory activities to be carried out in WP2 (governance, social innovation, business models), WP3 (system dynamics) and WP4 (transition pathways).

LITERATURE REFERENCES

ADDITIONAL FIELDS

Team members description - optional	
Specify the Funder	
Relevance to Funders' programme	
Person-Months	3
Theme(s):	2.2: Coordination among actors, social innovations and policies to enhance the agroecological transition
9-digit Participant Identification Code (PIC)	0001
Do you agree that we will use your contact data for our internal processes in AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
Are you a Beneficiary of (signatory of the Grant Agreement) the Partnership AGROECOLOGY?	No
I hereby confirm that I have not received any confidential information on this call and prior to the launch, which would result in an advantage towards other potential applicants	yes

Partner 12: AGROSMART CLUSTER

FINANCE COMMENTS

Personnel	9k€ Own contributions: 1 project manager, 3 PM
Travel	N/A
Consumables / Equipment	N/A
Subcontracts	N/A
Other	N/A

TEAM MEMBER

TASK(S)

The role of AGROSMART CLUSTER will be to participate as a key stakeholder in the project's initial set of in-depth interviews (T1.1) to help designing the involvement of young farners and characterising the local sustainable farming activities. AGROSMART CLUSTER will also be fundamental for the mapping and engaging with the broader set of relevant stakeholders (T1.2) and taking a role as EMPOWERALL local champion that can serve as a direct link with other stakeholders (especially young farmers), getting their feedback on the Work Plan to adjust critical activities to local needs. AGROSMART CLUSTER contribution will also be necessary in all the participatory activities to be carried out in WP2 (governance, social innovation, business models), WP3 (system dynamics) and WP4 (transition pathways).

LITERATURE REFERENCES

ADDITIONAL FIELDS

Team members description - optional	
Specify the Funder	
Relevance to Funders' programme	
Person-Months	3
Theme(s):	2.2: Coordination among actors, social innovations and policies to enhance the agroecological transition
9-digit Participant Identification Code (PIC)	882233431
Do you agree that we will use your contact data for our internal processes in AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
Are you a Beneficiary of (signatory of the Grant Agreement) the Partnership AGROECOLOGY?	No
I hereby confirm that I have not received any confidential information on this call and prior to the launch, which would result in an advantage towards other potential applicants	yes

Partner 13: Helmholtz Centre for Environmental Research UFZ

FINANCE COMMENTS

Personnel	9k€ Own contributions: 1 researcher, 3 PM
Travel	N/A
Consumables / Equipment	N/A
Subcontracts	N/A
Other	N/A

TEAM MEMBER

TASK(S)

eLTER RI will be fundamental for informing T4.1 in-depth assessment of (a) how the real-world situations represented by the AELLs can make eLTER RI's network of LTSER Platforms more applicable and impactful, and (b) LTSER network can provide foundational technical, data and scientific infrastructure within which the AELLs operate

LITERATURE REFERENCES

ADDITIONAL FIELDS

Team members description - optional	
Specify the Funder	
Relevance to Funders' programme	
Person-Months	3
Theme(s):	2.2: Coordination among actors, social innovations and policies to enhance the agroecological transition
9-digit Participant Identification Code (PIC)	999994632
Do you agree that we will use your contact data for our internal processes in AGROECOLOGY?	Yes
Are you a Beneficiary of (signatory of the Grant Agreement) the Partnership AGROECOLOGY?	No
I hereby confirm that I have not received any confidential information on this call and prior to the launch, which would result in an advantage towards other potential applicants	yes

SCIENCE POLICY INTERFACE CONTRIBUTION

EMPOWERALL will bridge scientific research and policymaking by co-producing place-based taylored transition pathways with young farmers, informing EU, national, and regional agroecology policies. EMPOWERALL contributes to the EU Green Deal goal of a fair, healthy, and environmentally-friendly food system; the Farm to Fork Strategy objectives of reducing dependency on pesticides and fertilizers and increasing organic farming; and CAP priorities of generational renewal, climate adaptation, and vibrant rural areas. The project's integration with eLTER RI ensures that evidence-based policy integration drives long-term sustainability in agrifood governance. Increasing youth inclusion and ensuring early participation in decision-making, will yield a more resilient, innovative, and socially equitable agrifood sector, positioning young farmers as the central agents of change in Europe's sustainable transition. Participatory system modelling and transition pathways will inform regional and national strategies, supporting coherent policy mixes and governance reforms. Most importantly, EMPOWERALL will promote rural youth participation in governance, while policy briefs and roadmaps will support uptake of inclusive, resilient, and climate-smart agrifood policies across scales.

FINANCES

Requested funding **[in k€]**

Organisation name	Personnel	Travel	Consumables / Equipment	Subcontracts	Other	Requested Funding	Total Own Contribution	Total Costs
CSIC (Spanish National Research Council)	109	23	0	0	9	176	87	263
Overhead	27	6	0	0	2			
Norwegian Institute of Bioeconomy Research	321	30	0	0	47	398	0	398
Overhead	0	0	0	0	0			
CEBC	145	12	0	0	21	178	43	221
Overhead	0	0	0	0	0			
GLOBAZ, S.A.	103	5	0	0	6	142	70	212
Overhead	26	1	0	0	1			
Universidad Pontificia Comillas	99	20	0	0	0	149	45	194
Overhead	25	5	0	0	0			
University of Bucharest	72	4	0	0	4	100	0	100
Overhead	18	1	0	0	1			
Agricultural Research and Development Station of Braila	72	3	5	0	0	100	0	100
Overhead	18	1	1	0	0			
Institute of Landscape Ecology	45	19	6	0	26	120	0	120
Overhead	11	5	2	0	6			
GODS	36	6	0	0	6	48	58	106
Overhead	0	0	0	0	0			

Organisation name	Personnel	Travel	Consumables / Equipment	Subcontracts	Other	Requested Funding	Total Own Contribution	Total Costs
SAS DLR	36	2	0	0	2	40	49	89
Overhead	0	0	0	0	0			
Asociación de Agricultores Puerta de Doñana	0	0	0	0	0	0	9	9
Overhead	0	0	0	0	0			
AGROSMART CLUSTER	0	0	0	0	0	0	9	9
Overhead	0	0	0	0	0			
Helmholtz Centre for Environmental Research UFZ	0	0	0	0	0	0	9	9
Overhead	0	0	0	0	0			
TOTAL	1163	143	14	0	131	1451	379	1830

1 k€ = 1000 €

Own contribution **[in k€]**

Organisation name	Personnel	Travel	Consumables / Equipment	Subcontracts	Other	Total Own Contribution
CSIC (Spanish National Research Council)	87	0	0	0	0	87
Norwegian Institute of Bioeconomy Research	0	0	0	0	0	0
CEBC	43	0	0	0	0	43
GLOBAZ, S.A.	70	0	0	0	0	70
Universidad Pontificia Comillas	45	0	0	0	0	45
University of Bucharest	0	0	0	0	0	0
Agricultural Research and Development Station of Braila	0	0	0	0	0	0
Institute of Landscape Ecology	0	0	0	0	0	0
GODS	58	0	0	0	0	58
SAS DLR	49	0	0	0	0	49
Asociación de Agricultores Puerta de Doñana	9	0	0	0	0	9
AGROSMART CLUSTER	9	0	0	0	0	9
Helmholtz Centre for Environmental Research UFZ	9	0	0	0	0	9
TOTAL	379	0	0	0	0	379

1 k€ = 1000 €

ETHICS ISSUES TABLE

1. Human Embryonic Stem Cells and Human Embryos

Does this activity involve Human Embryonic Stem Cells (hESCs)?

No

Does this activity involve the use of human embryos?

No

2. Humans

Does this activity involve human participants?

Yes

Does this activity involve interventions (physical also including imaging technology, behavioural treatments, etc.) on the study participants?

No

Does this activity involve conducting a clinical study as defined by the Clinical Trial Regulation (EU 536/2014)? (using pharmaceuticals, biologicals, radiopharmaceuticals, or advanced therapy medicinal products)

No

3. Human Cells / Tissues (not covered by section 1)

Does this activity involve the use of human cells or tissues?

No

4. Personal Data

Does this activity involve processing of personal data?

Yes

Does it involve the processing of special categories of personal data (e.g.: genetic, biometric and health data, sexual lifestyle, ethnicity, political opinion, religious or philosophical beliefs)?

No

Does it involve profiling, systematic monitoring of individuals, or processing of large scale of special categories of data or intrusive methods of data processing (such as, surveillance, geolocation tracking etc.)?

No

Does this activity involve further processing of previously collected personal data (including use of preexisting data sets or sources, merging existing data sets)?

No

Is it planned to export personal data from the EU to non-EU countries? Specify the type of personal data and countries involved

No

Is it planned to import personal data from non-EU countries into the EU or from a non-EU country to another non-EU country? Specify the type of personal data and countries involved

No

N/A

Does this activity involve the processing of personal data related to criminal convictions or offences?

No

5. Animals

Does this activity involve animals?

No

6. Non-EU Countries

Will some of the activities be carried out in non-EU countries?

No

N/A

In case non-EU countries are involved, do the activities undertaken in these countries raise potential ethics issues?

No

It is planned to use local resources (e.g. animal and/or human tissue samples, genetic material, live animals, human remains, materials of historical value, endangered fauna or flora samples, etc.)?

No

Is it planned to import any material (other than data) from non-EU countries into the EU or from a non-EU country to another non-EU country? For data imports, see section 4.

No

Is it planned to export any material (other than data) from the EU to non-EU countries? For data exports, see section 4.

No

Does this activity involve low and/or lower middle income countries, (if yes, detail the benefit-sharing actions planned in the self-assessment)

No

Could the situation in the country put the individuals taking part in the activity at risk?

No

7. Environment, Health and Safety

Does this activity involve the use of substances or processes that may cause harm to the environment, to animals or plants.(during the implementation of the activity or further to the use of the results, as a possible impact) ?

No

Does this activity deal with endangered fauna and/or flora / protected areas?

No

Does this activity involve the use of substances or processes that may cause harm to humans, including those performing the activity.(during the implementation of the activity or further to the use of the results, as a possible impact) ?

No

8. Artificial Intelligence

Does this activity involve the development, deployment and/or use of Artificial Intelligence? (if yes, detail in the self-assessment whether that could raise ethical concerns related to human rights and values and detail how this will be

addressed).

No

9. Other Ethics Issues

Are there any other ethics issues that should be taken into consideration?

No

I confirm that I have taken into account all ethics issues above and that, if any ethics issues apply, I will complete the ethics self-assessment as described in the guidelines How to Complete your Ethics Self-Assessmen

Yes, I confirm the statement above.

ETHICS SELF-ASSESSMENT

Ethical dimension of the objectives, methodology and likely impact

Some of the activities linked to the transdisciplinary action research to be carried out in the AELs will involve interviews and participant observation in workshops. Data analysis will involve the quantitative and content analysis of the gathered information, which will be rigorously anonymised and stored in a secure server with a strong firewall, and to which only selected scientists will have direct access.

Compliance with ethical principles and relevant legislations

At all steps, the legal and ethical rules established in the last relevant EU legislation will be followed closely by the project's coordinators. This legislation include: (1) REGULATION (EU) 2021/695 OF THE EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT AND OF THE COUNCIL (laying rules for participation and dissemination in Research and Innovation activities; (2) the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR). Specific measures to be taken include: (1) Informed consent through robust mechanisms to ensure consent, even in emergency scenarios; (2) data minimisation through strict limitation of data collection to only essential information; (3) privacy by design by building privacy protections into every project phase; (4) regular privacy updates and training for all team members where and if required.

SECURITY ISSUES TABLE

1. EU Classified Information (EUCI)

Does this activity involve information and/or materials requiring protection against unauthorised disclosure (EUCI)?

No

Does this activity involve non-EU countries which need to have access to EUCI?

No

2. Misuse

Does this activity have the potential for misuse of results?

No

3. Other Security Issues

Does this activity involve information and/or materials subject to national security restrictions? If yes, please specify: (Maximum number of characters allowed: 1000)

No

N/A

Are there any other security issues that should be taken into consideration? If yes, please specify: (Maximum number of characters allowed: 1000)

No

N/A

SECURITY SELF-ASSESSMENT

Security self-assessment

N/A

Curriculum Vitae

Name: Prof. Cristina Chaminade, PhD

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Date	Position – Institution - Country
05/2024 – present	Full professor - INGENIO (CSIC-UPV), Spanish National Research Council - Spain
08/2016- 05/2025	Full professor – Lund University School of Economics and Management - Sweden
07/2011- 07/2016	Full professor – CIRCLE, Lund University - Sweden
10/2007- 06/2011	Associate professor – CIRCLE, Lund University - Sweden
06/2005- 09/2007	Postdoctoral researcher – CIRCLE, Lund University - Sweden
9/2003 – 05/2005	Postdoctoral researcher – Fac. Economics and BA, Autonomous Univ. Madrid, Spain
4/2000 – 8/2003	Assistant professor - Fac. Economics and BA, Autonomous Univ. Madrid, Spain

PUBLICATIONS

Chaminade, C.; Dallaire-Fortier, C.; Hillbom, E. (2024) Sustainability transformations and the transformative capacity of nation-states: implications for innovation policy. *Journal of Innovation Economics and Management*. I181-XXVIII. https://doi.org/10.3917/jie.pr1.0181.

Angermayr, G.; Palacio, A.; Chaminade, C. (2023) Small-Scale Freshwater Aquaculture, Income Generation and Food Security in Rural Madagascar. *Sustainability*, 15 (21), 15439. https://doi.org/10.3390/su152115439

Palacio, A.; Chaminade, C. Angermayer, G. (2023) Pathways to a Sustainable Blue Economy in Latin America and the Caribbean in Borges de Brito, P.R. (Ed) *Implementing the UN Sustainable Development Goals- Regional Perspectives*. Vol. 1. Springer.

Aristi, A.; Bauer, F.; Chaminade, C. (2022) Emerging technologies supporting the transition to a circular economy in the plastic materials value chain. *Circular Economy and Sustainability*, 3, pp. 953-982. https://doi.org/10.1007/s43615-022-00209-2

Plechero, M. Kulkarni, M., Chaminade, C., Parthasarathy, B. (2021) Explaining the past, predicting the future: the influence of regional trajectories on innovation networks of new industries in emerging economies, *Industry and Innovation*. *28*(7), 932–954. https://www.tandfonline.com/doi/abs/10.1080/13662716.2020.1780419

Chaminade, C.; Randelli, F. (2020) The Role of Territorially Embedded Innovation Ecosystems Accelerating Sustainability Transformations: A Case Study of the Transformation to Organic Wine Production in Tuscany (Italy)*, Sustainability*, *12* (11), 4621. https://doi.org/10.3390/su12114621

Chaminade, C. (2020). Innovation for What? Unpacking the Role of Innovation for Weak and Strong Sustainability. *Journal of Sustainability Research*. Vol 2(1). https://doi.org/10.20900/jsr20200007

Bayuo, B. ; Chaminade, C. Göransson, B. (2020) Unpacking the role of universities in the emergence, development, and impact of social innovations – A systematic review of the literature. *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*, vol. 155. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.techfore.2020.120030

Bellandi, Marco & Chaminade, Cristina & Plechero, Monica (2020): Transformative paths and the multi-scalarity of knowledge bases under Industry 4.0 challenges. Chapter in de Propis and Bailey Industry 4.0: Transformational Regions. Routledge. https://www.routledge.com/Industry-40-and-Regional-Transformations/Propris-Bailey/p/book/9781032236629, https://doi.org/10.4324/9780429057984

Chaminade, C. Ballandi, M. Plechero, Santini , E. (2019) Understanding processes of path renewal and creation in thick specialized regional innovation systems. *European Planning Studies*, 27(10), pp. 1978-1994. https://doi.org/10.1080/09654313.2019.1610727

RESEARCH GRANTS AWARDED (same or related topic)

2024-2031 European partnership on accelerating farming systems transition – agroecology living labs and research infrastructures. Horizon Europe -CoFund actions, European Commission. Researcher (40%).

2024-2027 Confronting the climate - water - biodiversity interactions: how rural communities can choose to become sustainable. Formas. Researcher (20%)

2020-2024 *Sustainable development in Small Island Developing States.* Developmental Research. Swedish Research Council. Partner & draft of the proposal.

2020-2022 *Institutional change and the transition to the Bio-economy in Sweden (2020-2025) SWINNO 3.0.* Funded by VINNOVA, Main researcher [I left the project in January 2022].

AWARDS

06/1999 Best PhD thesis in Economics, Autonomous University of Madrid, Spain

Curriculum Vitae

Name: Giovanna Ottaviani Aalmo

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Date	Position – Institution - Country
11 2010 – present	Research Scientist Norwegian Institute of Bioeconomy Research (NIBIO) Norway

PUBLICATIONS

Li, Xiande, Zhilu Sun, Giovanna Ottaviani Aalmo, Fangfang Cao, Divina Gracia P. Rodriguez, Chen Qian, Yongxun Zhang, and Knut Øistad. "The Agro-Extension Service Evolution in China and Norway: Different Pathways to Tackle Evolving Challenges." In Innovation for Environmentally-friendly Food Production and Food Safety in China, pp. 181-203. Singapore: Springer Nature Singapore, 2023

G Ottaviani Aalmo, et al. 2022 Development of a novel framework for the assessment and improvement of climate adaptation and mitigation actions in Europe Frontiers in Sustainable Cities, 44

Scarascia-Mugnozza, Giuseppe E., Vicente Guallart, Fabio Salbitano, Giovanna Ottaviani Aalmo, and Stefano Boeri, eds. Transforming BioCities: Designing Urban Spaces Inspired by Nature. Vol. 20. Springer Nature, 2023.

Roglić, Marija, Louis Tessier, Giovanna Ottaviani Aalmo, Domenico Dentoni, Erwin Wauters, Fleur Marchand, Divina Garcia Rodriguez et al. "Mapping Systems Across Scales: A Methodological Framework for the ENFASYS Project." (2023).

Krasniqi, N., Blancard, S., Gjokaj, E., & Aalmo, G. O. (2023). Modelling technical efficiency of horticulture farming in Kosovo: An application of data envelopment analysis. *Bio-based and Applied Economics*, *12*(3), 183-195.

AWARDS

Date	Award Title – Awarding Institution
MM YYYY	Class President - NYU Stern School of Business

Curriculum Vitae

Name: Sabrina Gaba

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Date	Position – Institution - Country
01 2021 – present	Director of USC1339 Centre d'Etudes Biologiques de Chizé - France
02 2018 – present	Senior Researcher INRAE – USC1339 Centre d'Etudes Biologiques de Chizé - France
01 2017 - present	Co-PI LTSER Zone Atelier Plaine & Val de Sèvre
01 2017 – 01 2018	Senior Researcher INRAE – UMR Agroécologie, Dijon - France
01 2013 – 31 2016	Junior Researcher INRAE – UMR Agroécologie, Dijon - France
10 2007 – 31 2012	Junior Researcher INRAE – UMR Biologie et Gestion des Adventices, Dijon - France
01 2006 – 09 2007	Post-Doctorate, Basel University, Switzerland
11 2002 – 11 2005	PhD Student INRAE, IASP Tours & Biometrie Avignon, France

PUBLICATIONS

Faure, J., **Gaba, S**., Perrot, T., Bretagnolle, V., & Mouysset, L. (2025). Economic efficiency of nature-based solutions: Theoretical framework and application to semi-natural habitat implementation. Journal of Environmental Management, 373, 123793.

Cartailler, Y., Berthet, E. T., Durand, S., & **Gaba, S**. (2024). Farmers' limited perceptions of the role of ecological processes in crop production, a potential obstacle to agroecological transition. Journal of Rural Studies, 111, 103438.

Perrot, T., Rusch, A., **Gaba, S**., & Bretagnolle, V. (2023). Both long-term grasslands and crop diversity are needed to limit pest and weed infestations in agricultural landscapes. Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 120(49), e2300861120.

Pelosi, C., Bertrand, C., Appenzeller, B., Coeurdassier, M., ... , Gaba S., …, & Fritsch, C. (2023). In natura exposure of soil, earthworms and small mammals to pesticides in agricultural landscapes: from fears to fact.

Morales, M. B., Díaz, M., Giralt, D., Sardà-Palomera, F., ..., Gaba S., ... & Bota, G. (2022). Protect European green agricultural policies for future food security. Communications earth & environment, 3(1), 217.

Berthet, E. T., Bretagnolle, V., & **Gaba, S**. (2022). Place-based social-ecological research is crucial for designing collective management of ecosystem services. Ecosystem Services, 55, 101426.

Gaba, S., & Bretagnolle, V. (2020). Social–ecological experiments to foster agroecological transition. People and Nature, 2(2), 317-327.

Möhring, N., **Gaba, S**., & Finger, R. (2019). Quantity based indicators fail to identify extreme pesticide risks. Science of the total environment, 646, 503-523.

Bretagnolle, V., Berthet, E., Gross, N., Gauffre, B., Plumejeaud, C., Houte, S., ... & **Gaba, S**. (2018). Towards sustainable and multifunctional agriculture in farmland landscapes: lessons from the integrative approach of a French LTSER platform. Science of the Total Environment, 627, 822-834.

Gaba, S., Gabriel, E., Chadœuf, J., Bonneu, F., & Bretagnolle, V. (2016). Herbicides do not ensure for higher wheat yield, but eliminate rare plant species. Scientific reports, 6(1), 30112.

Name: Alexandros Koukovinis

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Date	Position – Institution - Country
1/2022 – Present	**Project Consultant – LOBA (EU Projects Department) – Portugal** Implementing strategic networking, proposal management and writing, and dissemination leading
1/2019 – 12/2021	**Project Consultant – INOVA+ (International Capacity Building and Cooperation) – Portugal** Networking, writing, coordinating, implementing, managing, and evaluating European projects
1/2016 – 12/2018	**Project Manager – SCIENCE VIEW (Science Communication) – Greece** Writing, coordinating, implementing, managing, and evaluating EU and National projects
1/2015 – 12/2016	**Researcher / Project Manager – National and Kapodistrian University of Athens – Greece** Managing and implementing EU and National projects

PUBLICATIONS

NA

AWARDS

NA

Name: Jorge Uroz Olivares

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Date	Position – Institution - Country
03 2019 – present	Head of Department, Sociology and Social Work – Universidad Pontificia Comillas
03 2019 – present	Member of the Board of the Faculty of Humanities and Social Sciences – Universidad Pontificia Comillas
06 2006 – present	Profesor Propio Adjunto (Associate Professor) - Universidad Pontificia Comillas

PUBLICATIONS

Uroz Olivares, J. (2022). “Infancia en situación de riesgo y desamparo: intervención desde el Trabajo Social” in Pérez Viejo, J., Lorenzo Gilsanz, F.J. y García Castillas, F.J. Trabajo Social en escenarios de vulnerabilidad. Una mirada para la inclusión social. Ed. Tirant Lo Blanch. Valencia

Uroz Olivares, J. (2022). “The Trafficking of Children for the Purpose of Sexual Exploitation in Spain” in Acharya, A. K., Bryson, J. C., Martinez Sanchez, M. Contemporary Slavery and Trafficking in Persons. Ed. Maya Publishing House. New Delhi.

Meneses-Falcón, C., Rúa-Vieites, A., & Uroz-Olivares, J. (2022). Exploring the role of Spanish judges in the investigation and prosecution of human trafficking for the purpose of sexual exploitation. Criminology & Criminal Justice, 22(4), 601-617. https://doi.org/10.1177/1748895820984820

Prieto-Ursúa, M., Charro Baena, B., Caperos J.M., Meneses Falcón, C., Uroz Olivares, J. (2020). Alcohol consumption in adolescents: The predictive role of drinking motives. Psicothema 32(2):189-196. doi: 10.7334/psicothema2019.263. PMID: 32249744.

Baena, B. C., Meneses, C., Caperos, J. M., Prieto, M., Uroz, J. (2019). The Role of Religion and Religiosity in Alcohol Consumption in Adolescents in Spain. *Journal of Religion and Health*, *58*(5), 1477–1487. http://www.jstor.org/stable/45216929

Meneses Falcón, M. C., Uroz Olivares, J. (2019). Identification, rescue, and social intervention with the victims of trafficking for sexual exploitation in Spain. In Bryson Clark, J. and Poucki, S. The SAGE Handbook of Human Trafficking and Modern Day Slavery. Sage. California. doi: 10.4135/9781526436146.n26

AWARDS

Date	Award Title – Awarding Institution

Curriculum Vitae

This template includes all needed information for the requested CV per partner/coordinator:

- *Full name incl. academic titles*
- *Professional affiliations*
- *Up to 10 relevant publications*
- *Research grants awarded relevant for this topic*

Please delete this textbox before using this template

Name: Cristian- Mihai ADAMESCU PhD

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Date	Position – Institution - Country
01 2007 – present	Researcher – Research Center in Systems Ecology and Sustainability - – Faculty Biology – University of Bucharest – Romania

PUBLICATIONS

Maasri, A., Jähnig, S.C., **Adamescu, M.C.,** Adrian, R., Baigun, C., Baird, D.J., et al. (2022) A global agenda for advancing freshwater biodiversity research. *Ecology Letters*, 25, 255–263. Available from: https://doi.org/10.1111/ele.13931

Angelstam, P., Manton, M., Elbakidze, M. **Adamescu, M.C** *et al.* LTSER platforms as a place-based transdisciplinary research infrastructure: learning landscape approach through evaluation. *Landscape Ecol* **34**, 1461–1484 (2019). https://doi.org/10.1007/s10980-018-0737-6

J.M. Holzer, C.M. **Adamescu, C.** Cazacu, R. Díaz-Delgado, J. Dick, P.F. Méndez, L. Santamaría, D.E. Orenstein, Evaluating transdisciplinary science to open research-implementation spaces in European social-ecological systems, Biological Conservation, Volume 238, 2019, 108228, ISSN 0006-3207, https://doi.org/10.1016/j.biocon.2019.108228

RESEARCH GRANTS

Date	Grant
2024	Restoration of wetland complexes as life supporting systems in the Danube Basin - Restore4Life - HORIZON-MISS-2022-OCEAN-01
2024	BioAgora - Developing the Science Service for European Research and Biodiversity Policymaking - HORIZON-CL6-2021-BIODIV-01
2023`	Science for Evidence-based and sustainabLe decIsions about NAtural capital – SELINA - HORIZON-CL6-2021-BIODIV-01-07
2023	Modelling RESTORation of wEtlands for Carbon pathways, Climate Change mitigation and adaptation, ecosystem services, and biodiversity, Co-benefits - RESTORE4C
2020	eLTER Plus H2020: European Long-Term Ecosystem Research infrastructures (2020-2026)

Curriculum Vitae – Daniela TRIFAN

Name: Dr. eng. Daniela TRIFAN

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Date	Position – Institution - Country
09 2019 – present	**General Director** – Agricultural Research and Development Station of Braila, Romania
11 2020 – present	**President** of Agrosmart Cluster, Romania
12 2012 – 09 2019	**Research scientist** - Agricultural Research and Development Station of Braila, Romania (full time from 12 2012 – 05 2014, and part time in other periods)
06 2018 – 03 2019	**Research scientist** – Monsanto Romania S.R.L.
05 2014 – 05 2018	**Research scientist** – BRAICOOP Agricultural Cooperative, Romania
10 2007 – 10 2012	**Assistant Lecturer** – Dunarea de Jos University of Galati, Faculty of Engineering and Agronomy of Braila, Romania

PUBLICATIONS

1. Daniela TRIFAN – Coordinator, (2023). *Conservation and improvement of soil and environmental resources through anti-erosion measures, measures to combat soil salination, sustainable bioremediate measures* – Bucharest University Publishing House,ISBN 978-606-28-1728-2, DOI: (Digital Object Identifier): 10.5682 /9786062817282

2. Daniela TRIFAN, Theodora Andreea TRIFAN, Emanuela LUNGU, Luxiţa RÎŞNOVEANU, Alin Ionel GHIORGHE, Daniel George ŞERBAN, (2023). *Increasing agricultural crops productivity through bioremediation methods of conserving soil and environmental resources,* International Congress of Health Sciences de la Izmir Democracy University, Turkey

3. Daniela TRIFAN - Volume Coordinator (2022). *AGRODATA Platform – User guide for farmers*. University Press, 2022, 99 pages, ISBN 978-606-28-0730-6, DOI (Digital Object Identifier): 10.5682/9786062807306

4. Daniela TRIFAN, Toader George, Lungu Emanuela, Ghiorghe Alin Ionel, Bardahan Valentin, Leopa Adrian, (2021). *Research protocol for the digitalization of agriculture in the Northern Baragan plain, Romania*. Research Journal of Agricultural Science, 53 (1), pag. 183-192, 2021. ISSN 2668-926X, ISSN 2066-1843 (printed form).

5. Daniela TRIFAN (invited speaker) (2021). *Global Climate Change, A New Challenge for Adapting Agricultural Technologies and Obtaining Healthy Food*. İzmir Demokrasi University International Congress of Health Sciences (ICHES-IDU 2021) - Izmir Demokrasi University International Congress of Health Sciences 2021 (ICHES-IDU 2021) Proceeding Book 12-13 November 2021 ISBN: 978-605-73858-7-1

6. Daniela TRIFAN, George Toader, Emanuela Lungu, Alin Ionel Ghiorghe, Viorica Bercea, Cătălin-Ioan Enea, Leonard Ilie, (2021). *The Transition of Romanian Agriculture: From Traditional Agriculture to a Digital, Sustainable Agriculture*. Proceedings of the 7th International Conference on Engineering and Natural Sciences (ICENS) (ICENS 2021), 23-27.06.2021 Bosnia-Herțegovina, ISBN 978-605-81426-1-9 ISSN 2687-2447

7. Daniela TRIFAN, Emanuela Lungu, Alin Ionel Ghiorghe, Popescu Nicolae, (2020). *Research about adaptation of agricultural technologies for successive crops, in the conditions of current climate changes and desertification phenomena in South-Eastern territory of Romania*, 3rd International Conference on Academic Research in Science, Technology and Engineering (ICARSTE), 27 - 29 November 2020 Dublin, Ireland

8. Daniela TRIFAN, Bularda M., Emanuela Lungu, Alin Ionel Ghiorghe, (2019). *Comparative Analysis of The Influence of Different Doses of Vegetal Bio Stimulator on Agricultural Productions*, Ziraat Fakültesi Dergisi 14 (1):89-96, 2019 ISSN 1304-9984, e-ISSN 2687-3419 Araştırma Makalesi

9. Daniela TRIFAN, Bularda M., Emanuela Lungu, (2019). *Studies on The Influence of Doses of The Plant Bio Stimulator and Solid Organic Substrate on Improving soil Fertility,* Ziraat Fakültesi Dergisi 14 (1):21-28, 2019 ISSN 1304-9984, e-ISSN 2687-3419 Araştırma Makalesi

10. Daniela TRIFAN – (2018). *Good practice guide on obtaining and using biofertilizers and plant biostimulants from agricultural waste and medicinal plants* – ISBN 978-606-28-0730-6, University Publisher Bucharest

RESEARCH GRANTS WITHIN LAST 5 YEARS

Date	Research Grants Title
2023 - 2026, director	"Measures and recommendations for reducing the risk of salinization and soil erosion under the influence of climate change",
2023 - 2026, director	"The establishment of agroforestry curtains and the study of their influence on anti-erosion protection and evapotranspiration of agricultural crops",
2020 – 2022, director	“Research on the digitization of agriculture in Northern Bărăgan Plain, through the use of drones and satellites, with the aim of monitoring crops and making agricultural technologies more efficient”,
2019 – 2022, director	"Research on the improvement of sowing technologies in successive or double crops of maize, sunflower, soybean and hemp for fiber and seeds",
2019 – 2022, director	"Creation of new lines of rice with characteristics of superior productivity and adaptability to the specific conditions of the northern limit of cultivation"

AWARDS

Date	Award Title – Awarding Institution
01 2024	**Award for Excellence in natural heritage conservation projects - Gala Green Report Romania** - The project submitted in 2023 referred to innovative natural heritage conservation projects, which include agroforestry curtains with anti-erosion and economic benefits, having fruit and energy species. Digitized monitoring allows technological interventions to reduce doses of phytosanitary treatments and maintain a clean environment.
02 2023	**Associat Member - Academy of Agricultural and Forestry Sciences Bucharest, Romania** - I was voted associate member for the integrated and good management of the research center I lead.
01 2023	**Award for Excellence in Agri-Food projects – Gala Green Report Romania** – The project submitted in 2022 was: Research on the digitalization of agriculture in the North Baragan Plain, through the use of drones and satellites, with the purpose of monitoring crops and improving agricultural technologies

Curriculum Vitae

Name: Dipl. Ing. Zuzana Baránková, PhD.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Date	Position – Institution - Country
September 2008 – April 2011	Researcher – Institute of Landscape Ecology – Slovak Academy of Sciences – Slovakia
May 2011 – May 2021	Maternity leave
June 2021 – now	Researcher – Institute of Landscape Ecology – Slovak Academy of Sciences – Slovakia

PUBLICATIONS

Baránková, Z., & Špulerová, J. (2023). Human–Nature Relationships in Defining Biocultural Landscapes: A Systematic Review. *Ekológia (Bratislava).* 42. 64-74. 10.2478/eko-2023-0008.

Izakovičová, Z., & Špulerová, J., & Baránková, Z., & Palaj, A. (2022). Perception of the Values of the Biocultural Landscape Types of Slovakia by the Population. *Land*. 11. 72. 10.3390/land11010072.

Baránková, Z. (2022). Ethnobotanical Knowledge through the Slovak Folk Songs as a Reflection of Intangible Biocultural Heritage. *Acta Societatis Botanicorum Poloniae*, *91*(1). https://doi.org/10.5586/asbp.9116

Conrad, E., & Cassar, L., & Jones, M., & Eiter, S., & Izakovičová, Z., & Baránková, Z., & Christie, M., & Fazey, I. (2011). Rhetoric and Reporting of Public Participation in Landscape Policy. *Journal of Environmental Policy & Planning*. 13. 23-47. 10.1080/1523908X.2011.560449.

Baránková, Z., Dobrovodská, M., Štefunková, D., Babicová, D., Moyzeová, M. & Petrovič, F. (2011). Participation of local people on identifying the landscape values and future development in historical agricultural landscapes. *Ekológia (Bratislava).* 30. 216-228. 10.4149/ekol_2011_02_216.

Baránková, Z., & Lieskovský, J., & Špulerová, J. (2024). Tracing the fate of hay meadows with haylofts in Slovakia: A geographical perspective. *Moravian Geographical Reports*. 32. 176-186. 10.2478/mgr-2024-0015.

Izakovičová, Z., & Moyzeová, M. & Bezák, P., & Dobrovodská, M., & Grotkovská, L., & Hrnčiarová, T., & Kenderessy, P., & Krnáčová, Z., & Majerčák, J., & Miklošovičová, Z., & Mojsej, M., & Pavličková, K., & Petrovič, F., & Špulerová, J., & Štefunková, D., & Válkovcová, Z. (2008). Hodnotenie poľnohospodárskej krajiny v tranzitívnej ekonomike. [Evaluation of Agricultural Landscapes in Transitional Economy]. Bratislava, 297 pp.

AWARDS

Date	Award Title – Awarding Institution
MM YYYY	

Name: François Teyssie

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Date	Position – Institution - Country
2021 – present	Directeur d'une association loi 1901 Groupe Ornithologique des Deux Sèvres
2020 – 2020	Conseiller entreprises agricoles à CERfrance à Barbezieux
2015 – 2020	Directeur de caisse d'Angoulême St Cybard au Crédit Mutuel du Sud-Ouest
2006 – 2014	Directeur de caisse de Mansle et la Rochefoucauld au CMSO
2001 – 2006	Responsable des crédits à l'agriculture en Dordogne au CMSO

PUBLICATIONS

N/A

AWARDS

N/A

Name: Baudouin de la Rochebrochard

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Date	Position – Institution - Country
2022 – 2025	Works supervisor - Bouygues Energies et Services
2022	Site worker - Atlanroute
2021	Site worker - Freres

PUBLICATIONS

N/A

AWARDS

N/A

Name: Pedro José Bañez García

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Date	Position – Institution - Country
2022 – present	Secretary of Comunidad de Usuarios de la Masa de Aguas Subterránea de La Rocina
2016 – present	Technician at Asociación de Agricultores Puerta de Doñana
2015 – present	Secretary of Comunidad de Regantes del Condado desde el año 2015 hasta la actualidad
2011 – 2019	Manager at Landonatur Ltd
2001 – 2011	Manager of DOÑANA FORESTAL Ltd
1999 – 2001	Técnico director del Museo Forestal de Almonte (Ayuntamiento de Almonte) desde el año 1999 año 2001

PUBLICATIONS

N/A

AWARDS

N/A

Curriculum Vitae

Name: PhD Student Eng system **SERBAN DANIEL GEORGE**

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Date	Position – Institution - Country
12 2020 – present	System Engineer – Braila Agricultural Research and Development Station – RO
09 2021 – present	Censor - Agrosmart Cluster - RO
10 2022 – present	PhD Student - "Lower Danube" University of Galati - RO

PUBLICATIONS

Author, Daniel George Serban, Emanuela Lungu, Daniela Trifan and Maria Magdalena Turek Rahoveanu (2023). Research On Digitization in Agricultural Farms from Romania. Journal Publication at the 41st IBIMA International Conference, volume 2023 (5), Article ID 4120323, https://doi.org/10.5171/2023.4120323

Author, Daniel George Serban, Emanuela Lungu, Daniela Trifan. (2024). IoT Evolution in Romanian Agriculture. International Conference on Trends & Innovations in Management, Engineering, Sciences and Humanities, volume(2024-01-23), https://doi.org/10.37082/IJIRMPS.ICTIMESH-23.15

Author, Daniel George Serban, Emanuela Lungu, Daniela Trifan. (2024). The importance of digitization and association in Romanian agricultural farms. ICRESB Journal 2024, volume(4-2024), ISSN 2810 – 5052 ISSN-L 2810 – 5052 DOI: 10.5682/28105052, https://www.icresb.scdabraila.ro/wp-content/uploads/2025/01/ICRESB-JOURNAL-VOL.-4-2024.pdf

Author, Daniel George SERBAN, Emanuela LUNGU, Florina Loredana SERBAN, Maria Magdalena TUREK RAHOVEANU. (2024). Smart Farming Technologies Existent in SE of Romania. International Journal of Scientific Research and Engineering Development, volume(ISERT-2024), https://zenodo.org/records/14677329

Author, , Daniel George SERBAN, Emanuela LUNGU, Florina Loredana SERBAN, Maria Magdalena TUREK RAHOVEANU. (2024). Digital transformation in the agricultural field 2023-2027. „Management, Economic Engineering in Agriculture and Rural Development", volume 4(4-2024), https://managementjournal.usamv.ro/pdf/vol.24_4/volume_24_4_2024.pdf

Author, Daniel-George SERBAN, Emanuela LUNGU, Florina Loredana SERBAN, Maria Magdalena TUREK RAHOVEANU, Daniela TRIFAN. (2025). Digitalization of Agriculture in Romania Potential, Challenges and Comparative Analysis. International Conference on Management, Engineering, Sciences

and Humanities 2025(MESH-2025), volume(MESH-2025 - Part 1), https://zenodo.org/records/15378312

AWARDS

Date	Award Title – Awarding Institution
06 2025	Honorable Mention - "Lower Danube" University of Galati – RO – Scientific Conference of the Doctoral School 13th Edition

Curriculum Vitae

Name: Pedro José Bañez García

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Date	Position – Institution - Country
2020 – present	Coordinator of the Preparatory Phase Project for eLTER RI - Helmholtz Centre for Environmental Research UFZ - Germany
2003 – 2017	Head of the Department for Ecosystem Research & Environmental Information Management of Environment Agency - Austria

PUBLICATIONS

Koukianaki, E.A., Lilli, M.A., Efstathiou, D., Matthews, B., Knaebel, K., Pröll, G., Kobler, J., Dirnböck, T., Bäck, J., Mirtl, M., Nikolaidis, N.P., 2025. Modeling soil functions of forested ecosystems. Journal of Environmental Management 386, 125636. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jenvman.2025.125636

Loescher, H., SanClements, M., Laney, C., Deshpande, K., Ruddell, B., Hagen, C., Morris, B., Mirtl, M., Porter-Bolland, L., Huber-Sannwald, E., Alvarado Barrientos, S., Pogosyan, L., Vargas, R., Sullivan, P., Villarreal, S., Cervantes-Jiménez, M., Bobadilla Ballesteros, M., Cerón-González, A., Lucía Prado Pano, B., Becerra Torres, E., Lopez Portillo, M., Avilés Junco, C., Yepez, E., Ceron, I., Girola, E., Guru, S., Mabee, P., Zacharias, S., Bäck, J., D'Onofrio, C., Bornman, T., Feig, G., Swetnam, T., Merchant, N., Specht, A., 2025. A Use Case Approach to Integrate Ecological Research Networks and Infrastructures to Advance Macrosystem Science. ACA 8. https://doi.org/10.3897/aca.8.e158965

Mirtl, M., T. Borer, E., Djukic, I., Forsius, M., Haubold, H., Hugo, W., Jourdan, J., Lindenmayer, D., McDowell, W.H., Muraoka, H., Orenstein, D.E., Pauw, J.C., Peterseil, J., Shibata, H., Wohner, C., Yu, X., Haase, P., 2018. Genesis, goals and achievements of Long-Term Ecological Research at the global scale: A critical review of ILTER and future directions. Science of The Total Environment 626, 1439–1462. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.scitotenv.2017.12.001

Ohnemus, T., Dirnböck, T., Bäck, J., Gaube, V., Kühn, I., Mirtl, M., Mollenhauer, H., Vereecken, H., Zacharias, S., 2025. Fitness for future: eLTER RI's representation of climate and land use change. Ecological Indicators 171, 113159. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ecolind.2025.113159

Ohnemus, T., Zacharias, S., Dirnböck, T., Bäck, J., Brack, W., Forsius, M., Mallast, U., Nikolaidis, N.P., Peterseil, J., Piscart, C., Pando, F., Poppe Terán, C., Mirtl, M., 2024. The eLTER research infrastructure: Current design and coverage of environmental and socio-ecological gradients. Environmental and Sustainability Indicators 23, 100456. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.indic.2024.100456

AWARDS

N/A

AGROSMART CLUSTER

DANIEL SERBAN

AGROECOLOGY

2nd Co-funded Call

Letter of Commitment

We hereby confirm that AGROSMART CLUSTER has sufficient resources and is committed to participating in the project **Empowering Young Farmers to Coordinate Agrifood Transformations through Engaged Research Infrastructures and Agroecological Living Labs - EMPOWERALL**

.

Agrosmart Cluster currently has 15 members, 10 of whom are farmers, and collaborates with Braicoop Cooperativa Agricola, which has over 60 farmers registered.

Thus, in the co-creation activities within the project, it will be able to make a significant contribution to the dissemination of information among farmers for the use of good practices in agroecology.

In accordance with the proposal which is submitted by Prof. Cristina Chaminade CSIC (Spanish National Research Council) – INGENIO (CSIC-UPV).

2nd June, 2025

Daniel Serban



ASOCIACIÓN DE AGRICULTORES PUERTA DE DOÑANA

PEDRO JOSE BAÑEZ GARCIA (TECNICO ASESOR)

AGROECOLOGY

2nd Co-funded Call

Letter of Commitment

We hereby confirm that ASOCIACIÓN DE AGRICULTORES PUERTA DE DOÑANA has sufficient resources and is committed to participating in the project EMPOWERALL.

In accordance with the proposal which is submitted by Cristina Chaminade Domínguez.

En Almonte a 13 de Junio de 2025

27909074T
JUAN MATOS
(R: G21318100)

Firmado digitalmente por 27909074T JUAN MATOS (R: G21318100)
Nombre de reconocimiento (DN): 2.5.4.13=Ref:AEAT/AEAT0440/PUESTO 1/100778/20012025144604, serialNumber=IDCES-27909074T, givenName=JUAN, sn=MATOS RODRIGUEZ, cn=27909074T JUAN MATOS (R: G21318100), 2.5.4.97=VATES-G21318100, o=ASOC DE AGRICULTORES PUERTA DE DOÑANA, c=ES
Fecha: 2025.06.16 19:37:59 +02'00'

Juan Matos Rodriguez.

Presidente.

Integrated European Long-Term Ecosystem, critical zone and socio-ecological Research

From:
Michael Mirtl
Chair of LTER-Europe
eLTER ESFRI Coordination

Helmholtz Centre for Environmental Research GmbH – UFZ
Permoserstraße 15
04318 Leipzig
Germany
michael.mirtl@ufz.de

AGROECOLOGY

2nd Co-funded Call

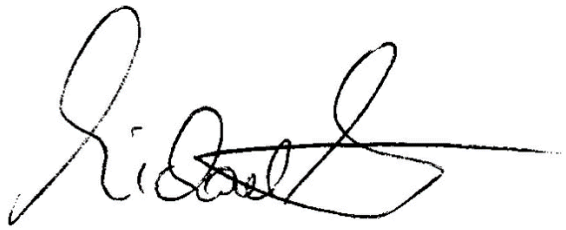
Letter of Commitment

I hereby confirm that eLTER RI has sufficient resources and is committed to participating in the project EMPOWERALL.

eLTER RI will act as external advisor to the project, in particular providing expert knowledge regarding the current status of its network of Facilities (LTER sites and LTSER Platforms), as well as its Standard Observations, in order to identify opportunities and gaps for a robust integration with the network of Agroecological Living Labs (AELLs) that will be built by EMPOWERALL.

In accordance with the proposal which is submitted by Cristina Chaminade Domínguez.

Sincerely,



Leipzig, 18th June 2025

Michael Mirtl

References

1 Bezner-Kerr, R., et al. 2023. Agroecology as a transformative approach to tackle climatic, food, and ecosystemic crises. Current Opinion in Environmental Sustainability 62:101275

2 Rockström, J., et al. 2023. Safe and just Earth system boundaries. Nature 619:102-111

3 Søgaard Jørgensen, P., et al. 2023. Evolution of the polycrisis: Anthropocene traps that challenge global sustainability. Philosophical Transactions of the Royal Society B: Biological Sciences 379:20220261

4 IPBES, 2024. Summary for Policymakers of the Thematic Assessment Report on the Interlinkages among Biodiversity, Water, Food and Health of the Intergovernmental Science-Policy Platform on Biodiversity and Ecosystem Services. IPBES secretariat, Bonn, Germany

5 Bohan, D. A., et al. 2022. Farmer-led agroecology for biodiversity with climate change. Trends in Ecology & Evolution 37(11):927-930

6 Leclère, D., et al. 2014. Climate change induced transformations of agricultural systems: Insights from a global model. Environ. Res. Lett. 9(12):124018

7 Fuchs, R., et al. 2020. Europe's Green Deal offshores environmental damage to other nations. Nature 586:671–673

8 Debonne, N., et al. 2022. The geography of megatrends affecting European agriculture. Global Environmental Change 75:102551

9 UNEP. 2021. Making Peace with Nature: A Scientific Blueprint to Tackle the Climate, Biodiversity and Pollution Emergencies. Nairobi.

10 IPCC. 2023. Summary for Policymakers. In: Climate Change 2023: Synthesis Report. Contribution of Working Groups I, II and III to the Sixth Assessment Report of the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change [Core Writing Team, H. Lee and J. Romero (eds.)]. IPCC, Geneva, Switzerland, pp. 1-34

11 Wezel, A., et al. 2020. Agroecological principles and elements and their implications for transitioning to sustainable food systems. A review. Agronomy for Sustainable Development 40:1-13

12 Pimber, M. 2017. Agroecology as an alternative vision to conventional development and climate-smart agriculture. Development 58:286-298

13 HLPE. 2019. High Level Panel of Experts on Food Security & Nutrition (HLPE) of the UN Committee on World Food Security (CFS): Agroecological Approaches and Other Innovations for Sustainable Agriculture & Food Systems that Enhance Food Security & Nutrition 2019. Rome: FAO

14 Gliessman, S. 2022. How do knowledge systems shape agroecology transitions?. Agroecology and Sustainable Food Systems 46(8):1115-1117

15 Mukwedeya, B. and M. Mudhara. 2024. Factors affecting rural youth participation in the smallholder farming sector. Journal of Agriculture, Food Systems, and Community Development 13(4): 259–275-259–275

16 Kote, P., et al. 2024. A Scoping Review on Youth Participation in Agriculture: Sustainable Development, Food Security, and Economic Growth. Journal of Scientific Research and Reports 30(5): 947-958

17 Giwu, O., et al. 2024. Evaluating factors influencing youth participation in agricultural enterprises: Implications for food security and agribusiness. Southern African Journal of Entrepreneurship and Small Business Management 16(1):1-11

18 Lopez-Ridaura, S. 2022. Agroecology and systems analysis for sustainable agriculture. 農林業問題研究 58(1):31-35

19 Meadows, D. 2015. Leverage points: places to intervene in a system. The Sustainability Institute

20 Bustamante Liria, M. d. P. 2024. From Theory to Practice: Leveraging Systems Thinking and Complexity Science to Support Food Systems Transformation, Agronomica

21 Berberi, A., et al. 2023. Enablers, barriers, and future considerations for living lab effectiveness in environmental and agricultural sustainability transitions: a review of studies evaluating living labs. Local Environment 1-19

22 Adefila, A. O., et al. 2024. Integrating traditional knowledge with modern agricultural practices: A sociocultural framework for sustainable development. Journal of Sustainable Agriculture and Development

Staff effort

Partner	WP1	WP2	WP3	WP4	WP5	WP6	Total
P1 (CSIC)	12	3	3	3	3	12	**36**
P2 (NIBIO)	1	2	12	2	1	1	**19**
P3 (CEBC)	3	2	1	26	1	3	**36**
P4 (LOBA)	1	1	1	1	29	1	**34**
P5 (UPCO)	3	8	8	3	1	1	**24**
P6 (UB)	1	1	1	8	1	1	**13**
P7 (SCDA)	3	3	3	19	1	1	**30**
P8 (ILE)	25	3	3	3	1	1	**36**
P9 (GODS)	0	0	0	11	0	1	**12**
P10 (SAS)	0	0	0	11	0	1	**12**

Work package 1 – Youth-driven AELLs definition, mapping and engagement within LTSER Platforms

WP1					
WP lead	CSIC	**Contributors**	NIBIO, CEBC, LOBA, UPCO, UB, SCDA, ILE	**Start – End**	M1-M12

Objectives

1) To conceptualise the project's youth-driven AELLs within the LTSER platforms and define the innovation spaces that they occupy within the platform's boundaries; 2) to identify and engage the relevant stakeholders as co-producers of the project's methodological framework; 3) to map the AKIS for each case at regional scale and as a foundation to leverage an agroecological AKIS; 4) to co-design the initial structure of the AELLs with a specific focus on the Youth Advisory Councils at their core

Description

Task 1.1: Conceptualising the youth-driven AELLs within the LTSER Platforms (M1-M9), lead: CSIC, contributors: NIBIO, CEBC, UPCO, UB, SCDA, ILE

T1.1 will conduct an exploratory study to gather preliminary insights about the AELLs contexts and existing sustainable farming initiatives within the project's four LTSER Platforms, within which a total of 4 youth-driven AELLs will be formalised (1 per Platform). The exploratory study will involve, first, a scoping literature review of the involved case LTSER Platforms, to characterise them at social-ecological level and their long-term research programs, thus providing the foundation for T4.1 (MS1.1, M4). Second, a general mapping of local sustainable farming initiatives within platform boundaries will be performed as a basis for informing the formalisation of AELLs (M5-M8). Data and information will be collected from background documents and research articles, and in-depth interviews with members from the consortium's local research teams and an initial group of key stakeholders from the identified initiatives, with special focus on youth representation (judgement sampling, integrated in T1.2 stakeholder mapping). The data and information gathered from both the scoping review and the general mapping will be processed conjointly through qualitative content analysis to produce preliminary synthesis narratives (D1.1, M9). These syntheses will offer a preliminary assessment about the potential (actual or realised) of the identified sustainable farming initiatives to be part of interweaved and broader youth-driven AELLs, the role that such AELLs currently play or might play in the future and the innovation niche they occupy within each LTSER Platform, and current AELL-LTSER linkages and knowledge exchange opportunities and gaps.

Task 1.2: Refinement of stakeholder mapping, engagement strategy and AKIS (M1-M12), lead: CSIC, contributors: CEBC, UPCO, UB, SCDA, ILE

T1.2 will first develop and implement a stakeholder engagement and management framework (M1-M8) paralleling T1.1 and in a coordinated way with T2.1 (project's methodological framework). The framework

will enable the identification, prioritisation, and participation monitoring for all the people to be engaged throughout EMPOWERALL. It will also enable a stakeholder categorisation based on their capacity to influence sustainable practices and social innovations (e.g., by using a power-interest grid). Thus, this task will constitute a systematic expansion of T1.1 into the local networks, by mapping and engaging with the broader set of relevant stakeholders (MS1.2, M8). Second, T1.2 will refine the stakeholders maps developed in the previous step to capture preliminary Agricultural Knowledge and Innovation Systems (AKIS) and Value Network Maps (VNMs) of the four target AELLs contextualised within their LTSER Platforms (M9-M11), which are a key input for T2.2. These AKIS and VNMs will be created using information from T1.1's in-depth interviews, further desk research and an online questionnaire to broader stakeholder groups (e.g., farmers, researchers, agricultural advisors and technicians, consultants, NGO representatives, decision makers, etc.). The methodology and resulting AKIS and VNMs will be published as a standalone report (D1.2, M12) that will constitute the basis of a full analysis of the current status of the agroecological AKIS in T2.2.

Task 1.3: Setting the foundations of the AELLs structure and the Youth Advisory Councils (M11-M12), lead: UPCO, contributors: CSIC, CEBC, LOBA, UB, SCDA, ILE

Most relevant knowledge and value holders/nodes identified during T1.2, will be invited to participate in 4 focus groups (1 per case, MS1.3, M12), prioritising the participation of young farmers. The focus groups will have three different goals: (a) to further refine the AKIS and VNMs, and validate that they reflect local dynamics; (b) to establish a steering group that will be guide the formalisation of project's AELLs; (c) to discuss a series of key guidelines for the governance of each AELL's, with a specific focus on the creation of Youth Advisory Councils at their core. These guidelines will be inspired by the governance models developed in Horizon GOV4ALL project, which focuses on the development of the first cohort of Soil Health Living Labs of the Soil Mission. Outputs from these discussions will represent the foundation to start strengthening the sustainable practice and innovation networks, and the establishment of the project's AELLs.

Deliverables	D1.1 – Preliminary synthesis narratives about AELL potential within LTSER Platforms (M9) – Lead: CSIC D1.2 – Technical report conveying the methodology for developing the AKIS and VNMs (M12) – Lead: CSIC
Milestones	MS1.1 – Scoping literature review about the four case LTSER Platforms (M4) – Lead: CSIC MS1.2 – Mapping and engagement of the relevant stakeholders by each local partner at their landscape level (M8) – Lead: CSIC MS1.3 – Focus groups at each AELL to establish governance guidelines for the Youth Advisory Councils finalised (M12) – Lead: UPCO
Risk and mitigation of risks	Risk 1.1 – The agenda of either stakeholders or partners will not fit EMPOWERALL schedule, hindering their active participation in the activities of the project (risk applies to whole project) – Mitigation measure: delegated responsibilities can well substitute the those people with highly conflicting agendas and online participation can be encouraged Risk 1.2 – Lack of clarity in the AELLs collaborative work can lead to inefficiencies in AELL creation and stakeholders and partners losing interest (risk applies to whole project) – Mitigation measure: implement strong preparatory processes to inspire stakeholders and partners to align with the goals of the AELL Risk 1.3 – Stakeholder fatigue poses an organisational challenge to the stakeholders – Mitigation measure: individual partners have committed to organise a feasible number of events, which in total is five per AELL, a fair number for a 3-year project

Work package 2 – Systemic methodological framework and initial diagnosis of current situation of AELLs

WP2					
WP lead	UPCO	**Contributors**	NIBIO, CEBC, LOBA, UPCO, UB, SCDA, ILE	**Start – End**	M1-M18

Objectives

1) To co-design the project's methodological framework based on a participatory systems-modelling approach, providing EMPOWERALL with a robust foundation across WP1-4; 2) to conduct a systemic diagnosis of the current situation of the AELLs within LTSER Platform boundaries, including an initial assessment of desired futures; 3) to provide actionable insights on governance, social innovation and business models supporting agroecological transitions

Description

Task 2.1: Development of a Participatory Systems Modelling framework (M1-M12), lead: UPCO, contributors: CSIC, NIBIO, CEBC, LOBA, UB, SCDA, ILE

T2.1 focuses on the co-design of a Participatory Systems Modelling (PSM) framework to support transdisciplinary analysis and co-creation across the four AELLs. Stakeholders from the AELLs will be engaged in the co-design process, to ensure the integration of diverse perspectives, knowledge forms and experiential insights, and to be more responsive to the different AELL local contexts, needs and situations. To prevent stakeholder fatigue and using insights from T1.2, the PSM co-design process will be achieved by identifying and involving a subset of representative stakeholders, with a focus on young farmers, showing more eagerness to participate as co-creators and core contributors (MS2.1, M6). Where required, broader consultations will be performed. The core modelling approach will centre on Causal Loop Diagrams (CLDs) to visualise systemic interconnections and feedback loops. CLDs will be fully implemented during WP3 (see below). During T2.1, CLDs will be integrated methodologically with a series methods and techniques suited to address complexity, uncertainty and learning in real-world settings (e.g., Fuzzy Cognitive Mapping, System Dynamics. In addition, based on prior and ongoing experiences in other projects (e.g., Climate KIC's MOTION, Horizon's GOV4ALL), CSIC will collaborate with UPCO on the robust integration of state-of-the art tools from transformative change research to support T4.2's effort for the co-design of transition and impact pathways for each AELL. These tools will integrate key concepts for the understanding of scaling dynamics and multi-level socio-technical and socio-ecological change (e.g., transitions theory, Three Horizons Framework). A final version of the PSM will be produced in M10 (D2.1) and UPCO will run a "train the trainers" session for all Consortium partners (MS2.2, M12) to ensure the harmonization of its implementation across the four cases and the comparability of results and modelling outputs.

Task 2.2. Analysis of current Agroecological Knowledge and Innovation Systems (M9-M15), lead: CSIC, Contributors: CEBC, UB, SCDA, ILE

In T2.2, CSIC will perform an in-depth, system-wide analysis of the current status of key socio-institutional agroecological components of the AKIS in which the 4 AELLs are embedded, distilling data from T1.1-1.3, and further desk research and in-depth interviews if/when required with relevant stakeholders from each AELL. The core focus of this analysis will be on the social networks, institutional framework and governance arrangements at the core of the agroecological AKIS, as well as their structural vulnerability related to their current endogenous capacities and resources, and external influences. Special attention will be given to the diversity of actors involved, including farmers, researchers, civil society organisations, and public institutions, as well as the geography of these relationships (local, regional and extra-regional) and their changes over time. Equally important, the analysis will look at knowledge networks and their geography, as the adoption of particular innovations might require knowledge not be available in the regions where the

AELLs are located. Regarding governance models, and depending on each AELL local context and requirements, organisational, local, national, and international governance levels and key institutional arrangements (e.g., dominant rules) and discursive practices (e.g., hegemonic ideas) will be analysed, as well as barriers and enablers of novel governance models enhancing the agroecological AKIS for each AELL, as well as the further development and integration of the Youth Advisory Councils. A full report extending D1.2 will be produced in M15 (D2.2)

Task 2.3: Analysis of agroecological social innovations linked to novel business models for achieving desired futures (M1-M18), lead: CSIC, contributors: NIBIO, CEBC, LOBA, UPCO, UB, SCDA, ILE

Based on interim outputs from T2.2 research process and again distilling data from T1.1-1.3, T2.3 will map current agroecological innovations that fit co-produced desired futures at each AELL's local scale. This mapping will include business models and network configurations that could enable change towards such desired futures. For those purposes, this task will first perform an in-depth literature review on agroecological innovations and business models worldwide, including technological, social and institutional innovations (M1-M9), paralleling T1.1 exploratory study. Then, paralleling the last stages of T2.2, T2.3 will identify a potential portfolio of emerging agroecological innovations and business models within each AELL (M10-M15). This portfolio and results from the prior in-depth literature review, together with T1.2 synthesis narratives and final results from T2.2's in-depth AKIS analysis, will be the main inputs to participatory workshops at each AELL during M16-M17. In those workshops, using futures-thinking tools, a group of representative stakeholders involving selected groups of young farmers from each AELL, will first prototype a set of desirable futures that fit in the values, skills and ambitions of such young farmers. Prior to the workshops, CSIC will also run a "train the trainers" session (MS2.3, M15). Based on previously identified agroecological innovations and innovative business models, participants at the four AELL workshops (MS2.4, M17) will discuss and co-create preliminary local upscaling interventions and pathways of change that are desirable and feasible in their AELLs from a local and micro-level perspective, but embedded in their current existing system. Outputs from these workshops (D2.3, M18) will be refined and complemented during WP3 multiscale system diagnoses, and together with outputs from such diagnoses, will constitute the foundation of T4.2'S foresight exercises and T4.3's policy impact pathways at network scale for the set of the four AELLs within their LTSER Platforms.

Deliverables	D2.1 – Participatory Systems Modelling framework for AELLs youth-led agroecology upscaling (M10) – Lead: UPCO D2.2 – Full report including in-depth socio-institutional analyses of the AKIS for each AELL within LTSER Platforms, extending D1.2 technical report (M15) – Lead: CSIC D2.3 – Technical report on local-scale desirable futures and emergent agroecological innovations and business models for each AELL (M18) – Lead: CSIC
Milestones	MS2.1 – Identification of representative stakeholders to be involved in the development of the Participatory Systems Modelling framework (M6) – Lead: UPCO MS2.2 – Training session on the application of Participatory Systems Modelling framework for youth-led AELLs (M12) – Lead: UPCO MS2.3 – Training session on the use of the scaling dynamics and futures-thinking tools for youth-led AELLs (M15) – Lead: CSIC MS2.4 – Workshops with each AELL on desirable futures and emerging agroecological innovations and business models (M16-M18) – Lead: CSIC and coordinating partners at each AELL
Risk and mitigation of risks	Risk 2.1 – Difficulty integrating diverse modelling methods. Mitigation measure: early piloting and testing. Advise from experienced modellers, engagement with LTSER modellers

	Risk 2.2 – Limited data and evidence for systemic diagnosis. Mitigation measure: mixed-methods approach, triangulation Risk 2.3 – Disruption of in-person participation. Mitigation measure: hybrid and on-line engagement and participatory tools. Contingency planning Risk 2.4 – Difficulties understanding the Participatory Systems Modelling framework (risk applies to whole project's methodological approaches). Mitigation measure: simple vocabulary, engaging games, clear outcomes, diversity of communication outlets

Work package 3 – System analysis and dynamics for youth-led agroecological innovations

WP3					
WP lead	NIBIO	**Contributors**	NIBIO, CEBC, LOBA, UPCO, UB, SCDA, ILE	**Start – End**	M15 – M24

Objectives

1) To understand and uncover systemic "lock-ins" and "levers" hindering the diffusion of agroecological innovations and the creation of the AELLs; 2) to integrate systemic methods for a holistic understanding of agrifood system structures within LTSER Platforms, and how collective behaviours, in turn, shape the system; 3) to develop a knowledge base of common sets of variables that can act as levers of change across context (Transformative Archetypes) and that can inform both local transition pathways and higher-level policies to support such pathways across different regions

Description

Task 3.1: Causal Loop Diagram co-production (M15-M21), lead: NIBIO, contributors: CSIC, CEBC, UPCO, UB, SCDA, ILE

WP3 constitutes a highly-targeted series of activities drawing on the experience and state-of-the-art methods and tools combining systems and behavioural approaches acquired during ENFASYS Project. Building on the Participatory Systems Modelling frameworks from WP2 and following a "train the trainers" approach (MS3.1, M18), NIBIO, in collaboration with each AELL, will gather core stakeholders (young farmers, advisors, researchers and policy-makers), in facilitated Causal Loop Diagram (CLD) workshops (MS3.2). In these sessions, participants will map the key variables and feedback loops shaping farming and agrifood dynamics in their region, identifying reinforcing and balancing processes that drive or hinder agroecological transitions. The workshops (M20–M21) will produce a draft CLD which will be iteratively refined through expert review and, where necessary, participant validation surveys.

Task 3.2: Identification lock-ins and leverage points (M21-M24), lead: UPCO, contributors: CSIC, NIBIO CEBC, UB, SCDA, ILE

Using the validated CLDs from each AELL ready for cross-case analysis, a structured analysis will be performed to pinpoint the system's critical lock-ins, self-reinforcing loops that inhibit change, and strategic leverage points where small interventions can trigger cascade effects. Through quantitative CLD metrics (e.g., loop polarity and strength) and involving targeted online focus groups with each AELL (MS3.3, M22-M23), the analysis will be grounded in local experience. These findings will be synthetised into an Locks & Levers Compendium (D3.1, M24), ranking leverage points by feasibility and potential impact, and providing early recommendations for T4.2's transitions-pathway design. In addition, CSIC will explore and include in the Compendium a preliminary assessment of how a common systems-thinking approach used by the AELLs can be made interoperable with the methodological approaches, modelling tools and Standard Observation used by each LTSER Platforms. This will inform T4.1 by providing the basis for further harmonisation across LTSER Platforms and enhancing potential for comparative studies at eLTER RI level.

Task 3.3: Identification and clustering of transformative archetypes (M23-M27), lead: NIBIO, contributors: NIBIO, CEBC, LOBA, UPCO, UB, SCDA, ILE

A cross-case synthesis will be done to identify common "transformative archetypes" i.e. mid-range patterns of variables and feedback structures that recur across two or more AELLs. NIBIO, in strong collaboration with UPCO and CSIC; will group similar CLD sub-structures (e.g., youth-led innovation cascades, market-access loops) into archetype families. A final validation online workshop (MS3.4, M26) will be organised with consortium partners and external experts to discuss the relevance and transferability of each archetype. By M27, WP3 will deliver a Transformative Archetypes Catalogue (D3.2), detailing each pattern's defining loops, contextual enablers/barriers, and implications for scalable agroecological interventions in T4.2.	
Deliverables	D3.1 – Technical report including the Locks & Levers Compendium (M24) – Lead: NIBIO D3.2 – Technical report including the Transformative Archetypes Catalogue (M27) – Lead: UPCO & CSIC
Milestones	MS3.1 – Training session on participatory development of CLDs (M18) – Lead: NIBIO MS3.2 – CLD workshops at each AELL (M20-M21) – Lead: NIBIO and coordinating partners at each AELL MS3.3 – Targeted CLD focus groups at each AELL (M22-M23) – Lead: UPCO & CSIC and coordinating partners at each AELL MS3.4 – Expert validation workshop for the Transformative Archetypes Catalogue (M26) – Lead: UPCO & CSIC
Risk and mitigation of risks	WP2 and WP3 share the same risks and mitigation measures

Work package 4 – AELLs-LTSER network interactions to inform youth-led agroecological transition and policy impact pathways

WP4					
WP lead	UB (lead); CEBC (co-lead)	**Contributors**	CSIC, NIBIO, LOBA, UPCO, SCDA, ILE, GODS, SAS DLR	**Start – End**	M12 – M24

Objectives

1) To assess gaps and synergies between AELLs and LTSER Platforms; 2) to synthesize outputs from WP1, WP2 and WP3 into integrated transition pathways for each AELL; 3) to design roadmaps for other LTSER Platforms to develop future AELLs within their boundaries and new LTSER Platforms with higher impact on real-world challenges; 4) to identify policy and governance leverage points for upscaling youth-led agroecological innovation across Europe

Description

Task 4.1: Integrated cross-task analysis and synthesis (M6-M34), lead: UB & SCDA, contributors: CSIC, CEBC, ILE

This task will distil key project results and insights by synthesizing, on an ongoing basis, the outcomes from WP1, WP2 and WP3, in order to inform two key efforts. Paralleling the production of the main outputs from those WPs, the task will inform an in-depth assessment of (a) how the real-world situations represented by the AELLs can make eLTER RI's network of LTSER Platforms more applicable and impactful, and (b) LTSER network can provide foundational technical, data and scientific infrastructure within which the AELLs operate (M6-M24). A general goal will be to evaluate how insights from such real-world situations can actively help identifying and contribute to cover current gaps for the further advancement of LTSER Platforms, so that they better prepared to contribute to the co-creation of innovative approaches to seek solutions to such challenges in the near future. A specific focus will be on

how to improve the recently developed eLTER RI Standard Observation framework (https://elter-ri.eu/standard-observations-spheres), a set of key variables aimed at characterising the state and future trends of the Earth system from an ecological and socio-ecological perspective. On the other hand, however, T4.1 will also assess how LTSER Platforms vast transdisciplinary research expertise, modelling approaches and data tools developed over the last two decades, might also be already informative for the more user-centric, open-innovation process embedded in the AELLs. The more general questions are (a) how long-term research and monitoring infrastructures can support agroecological innovation, (b) how AELLs can help enhance standardized observation systems and harmonized research methods through real-world problem-solving, or (c) what methodological, data and institutional innovations are needed for reciprocal integration. T4.1 will iteratively build a structured knowledge base to underpin upscaling strategies and support systems-informed transition processes in T4.2. An interim report will be delivered in M18 (D4.1) for internal review by partners, especially by EMPOWERALL's advisors from eLTER RI. A final report will be delivered in M34 (D4.2).

Task 4.2: Co-design of transition and impact pathways for each AELL (M27-M34), lead: CEBC, contributors: UPCO, UB, CSIC, GODS, SAS DLR

Building on the integrated knowledge base from T4.1, T4.2 will support each AELL in co-designing their own context-sensitive transition and impact pathways, reflecting local system dynamics, stakeholder priorities, and agroecological opportunities. Task 4.2 is grounded on real-world challenges, and will seek across the four AELLs to describe, investigate, analyse and compare transition pathways currently in progress, or those that could be initiated, depending on each case. After a "train the trainers" session (MS4.1), the process will apply a participatory foresight approach in local workshops at each of the AELLs (MS4.2, M28-M29), grounded on (a) a network of real-world situations that will be different depending on the AELLs specificities and local contexts, elicited across WP1-3 and (b) the outputs from T2.3's futures-thinking tools (D2.3) and T3.3's Transformative Archetypes catalogue (D3.2). The foresight approach at each AELL will be aimed at providing a scenario-based thinking framework to local groups of relevant young farmers, local champions, decision makers and other key AELL stakeholders. Each pathway will include (a) a vision for the desired future agroecological state of the AELLs within the regional-scale boundaries of their respective LTSER Platforms, but connected at larger scales with their value chains and the food system; (b) actions, partnerships, and institutional changes needed to overcome identified lock-ins and activate leverage points (from WP3); (c) a timeline with short-, medium-, and long-term goals, policy entry points, and evaluation checkpoints; (d) a strategy for integrating AELL transitions into the LTSER Platform context, ensuring alignment with long-term socio-ecological monitoring and data infrastructures (eLTER RI Standard Observation framework); (e) an assessment on the potential institutionalisation opportunities and barriers for the institutionalisation of the Youth Advisory Councils (f) impact targets connected to biodiversity conservation, soil health, climate resilience, youth engagement, and business innovation. Cross-case synthesis of the various pathways will highlight common and specific pathway elements across AELLs, identifying shared barriers, replicable levers, and diversity of strategies. The resulting insights (D4.3) will feed into the roadmap development (T4.3), as well as feed back into WP3's CLDs, in order to produce generalisable models for transition support in other European regions. D4.3 will also include methodological templates and tools that can be used by future AELLs hosted within LTSER Platforms to initiate their own transition planning processes.

Task 4.3: EU level recommendations for transformative policies and governance (M27-M36), lead: CSIC, contributors: UB, SCDA, CEBC, NIBIO, COMILLAS

T4.3 will develop recommendations for increasing the integration and coherence among the EU environmental and agricultural policy mixes, and the strategies underlying the EU Green Deal, including, but not limited to, the Farm to Fork Strategy, the EU Biodiversity Strategy for 2030 and the action plan for the development of organic production (D4.4, M36). This task will also work to strengthen EU initiatives, by promoting the further inclusion of the project's AELLs into the Agroecology Partnership and the ALL-Ready Pilot Network, and collaborating with the nascent Soil Health Living Labs network of the Soil Mission, to align agroecological transitions with key European environmental policy goals. Specific

emphasis will be made on the insights gathered from the AELLs young farmers, in order to provide recommendations institutionalizing the participation of young farmers and the rural youth in relevant multi-level governance and policy settings to foster agroecological transitions (e.g., through the Youth Advisory Councils), and leveraging their role in contributing to overcome key lock-in dynamics and acting upon fundamental leverage points.	
Deliverables	D4.1 – Interim report on scaling conditions and LTSER-AELL gaps and interactions (M18) – Lead: UB D4.2 – Synthesis report on scaling conditions and LTSER-AELL gaps and interactions (M34) – Lead: UB D4.3 – Report on description and retrospective analysis of Transition Pathways for each AELL and their impacts (M34) – Lead: CEBC D4.4 – EU-level policy recommendations for scaling agroecological transitions (M36) – Lead: CSIC
Milestones	MS4.1 – Training session on foresight approach (M27) – Lead: CEBC, with support from UPCO, UB and CSIC MS4.2 – Foresight workshops informing further LTSER-AELLs integration (M28-M29) – Lead: CEBC, with support from UPCO, UB and CSIC
Risk and mitigation of risks	Risk 4.1 – Fragmentation or inconsistency of data and outcomes across the four AELLs, which may limit the comparability and coherence of the synthesis. Mitigation measure: applying a harmonised methodological framework and shared data templates Risk 4.2 – Limited engagement or availability of key stakeholders for the validation process. Mitigation measure: early coordination and flexible formats to ensure wide participation in the synthesis workshops

Work package 5 – Dissemination, Exploitation and Communication

WP5					
WP lead	LOBA	**Contributors**	CSIC, NIBIO, CEBC, UPCO, UB, SCDA, ILE	**Start – End**	M1 – M36
Objectives					
1) To raise awareness and foster engagement among all relevant stakeholders about EMPOWERALL's activities, achievements, and impacts; 2) To ensure the accessibility and visibility of project outcomes through inclusive, multi-format communication across tailored channels; 3) to support the exploitation and sustainability of project results through strategic planning, stakeholder alignment, and integration into existing networks and infrastructures					
Description					
Task 5.1: Dissemination, Exploitation and Communication Strategy (M1-M36), lead: LOBA, contributors: CSIC This task will define and implement an integrated Dissemination, Exploitation and Communication (DEC) strategy to ensure strong visibility, reach, and engagement with EMPOWERALL's target audiences. The strategy will be aligned with project objectives and coordinated with other WPs, closely aligned with T5.3 and T6.1, to identify and promote relevant outputs. The DEC strategy will emphasise youth involvement in agroecology and support the long-term sustainability of the project outcomes. The first version of the DEC Plan (D5.1) will be delivered by M4, with updates at M18 and M30 informed by continuous monitoring and stakeholder feedback. The strategy will focus on ensuring that the project is effectively communicated to both technical and non-technical audiences, using compelling storytelling and actionable knowledge in the					

form of videos, infographics and case studies. Special attention will be given to the AELLs, with a focus on communicating their insights and activities in a clear and inclusive manner for both technical and non-technical audiences. The impact assessment will be embedded throughout the task, using both qualitative and quantitative indicators (e.g., website traffic, media reach, stakeholder feedback) to track performance, guide adjustments, and report on outreach effectiveness. The integrated DEC strategy will help ensure EMPOWERALL's results are visible, accessible, and contribute to lasting agroecological transformation led by young farmers. In parallel, this task will also develop the Exploitation and Sustainability Plan, detailing the project's IPR management strategy, asset catalogue, and exploitation pathways. The plan will identify key exploitable results and their target user groups, along with appropriate mechanisms for ensuring uptake and long-term sustainability. It will cover general terms of use, IPR provisions, and strategies for valorising project outputs, whether through policy uptake, open access and community adoption.

Task 5.2: Communication channels and activities (M1-M36), lead: LOBA, contributors: CSIC, NIBIO, CEBC, UPCO, UB, SCDA, ILE

This task will establish and manage EMPOWERALL's communication channels, actions, and materials to ensure strong visibility, reach, and engagement with target groups and stakeholders. It will ensure that project activities, outcomes, and impacts are widely and effectively shared. The project website will be developed in two phases: a splash page by M2 to ensure early visibility, followed by the full site launch in M5 as the main hub for content and updates. A strong social media presence will be built—initially on Instagram and LinkedIn—with other platforms (e.g., Bluesky, Threads, Mastodon, TikTok) evaluated early on. A unified visual identity, including the project logo, templates, and promotional materials (e.g., brochures, posters, roll-ups), will ensure consistency and recognition. Stakeholder engagement will be reinforced through regular newsletters, press releases, and targeted mailings, complemented by media outreach and tailored campaigns promoting milestones and results. The task will also focus on producing accessible and engaging "actionable knowledge" from project activities. Outputs will include videos, interviews, infographics, and concise booklets tailored to diverse audiences, using compelling storytelling and visual formats to translate complex findings into clear, engaging narratives. Insights from the AELLs and other work packages will be prominently featured to support uptake by young farmers, practitioners, policymakers, and the broader public.

Task 5.3: Outreach activities (M1-M36), lead: CSIC, contributors: NIBIO, CEBC, LOBA, UPCO, UB, SCDA, ILE

This task will focus on active dissemination and outreach to promote EMPOWERALL's findings, innovations, and policy insights to key audiences across research, practice, and policy. The goal is to ensure that the project's results reach and resonate with relevant stakeholder groups, particularly young farmers, researchers, civil society organisations, and decision-makers, at local, national, and European levels. Active dissemination strategies will include participation in key conferences, policy dialogues, academic forums, and practitioner workshops to present the project's progress and outcomes. In addition, we will contribute to peer-reviewed open-access journals, submit articles to policy papers. These activities will seek to maximise the visibility of EMPOWERALL's findings and encourage cross-project learning. A comprehensive strategy for outreach activities linked to D5.1 will be produced by M6 (MS5.2) and executed through out the project's lifecycle, based on an in-depth scanning of agroecology, policy and academic outlets where EMPOWERALL can maximise the impact its core messages and synergies with sister initiatives and related communities.

Deliverables	D5.1 – Initial Dissemination, Exploitation and Communication Plan (M4) – Lead: LOBA D5.2 – Mid-term Dissemination, Exploitation and Communication Plan (M18) – Lead: LOBA D5.3 – Final Dissemination, Exploitation and Communication Plan (M30) – Lead: LOBA
Milestones	MS5.1 – Website launch (M5) – Lead: LOBA

	MS5.2 – Strategy for outreach activities linked to DEC Plan (M6) – Lead: CSIC
Risk and mitigation of risks	Risk 5.1 – Low engagement from target audiences and stakeholders: Mitigation: The project will develop audience-specific messaging and formats early in the project. Use existing networks (e.g. AELLs, Agroecology Partnership, eLTER RI) to boost reach and relevance. Regularly monitor engagement metrics to adapt strategies accordingly Risk 5.2 – Delays in setting up project communication channels (website, social media) Mitigation: Clear responsibilities and deadlines will be defined and assigned for the setup and review of all communication channels Risk 5.3 – Failure to meet communication and dissemination KPIs Mitigation: The DEC Plan will establish realistic, measurable KPIs from the outset and ensure their regular monitoring. Performance will be tracked using analytics tools, enabling strategic adjustments where needed. Efforts will be reallocated to the most effective channels, and partner networks will be activated to strengthen reach in underperforming areas

Work package 6 – Project coordination and management

WP6					
WP lead	CSIC	**Contributors**	NIBIO, LOBA, CEBC, UPCO, UB, SCDA, ILE	**Start – End**	M1 – M36
Objectives					
1) To set up the governing bodies for the project; 2) to establish clear guidelines for managing the project; 3) to support the consortium in fulfilling administrative and legal requirements; 4) to ensure the successful submission of the proposed deliverables					
Description					
Task 6.1: Scientific coordination within the project and across multiple initiatives (M1-M36), lead: CSIC, contributors: NIBIO, CEBC, LOBA, UPCO, UB, SCDA, ILE In T6.1, CSIC will develop a Project Management Manual (D6.1, M6), which will include guidelines for project administration and the management of deliverables and briefings to the Agroecology Partnership (AEP), to ensure timely reporting and complying with the 'Project Monitoring' (MTR at M18 and ETR). The project's Steering Committee (SC) will carry out check-ins every 3 months to oversee progress, and share challenges and successes. Before submitting any document, its content will be reviewed by at least 2 members of the SC. After the project kick off (M1), two consortium meetings (will be celebrated at M18 (MS6.1, aligned with MTR) and M34 (MS6.2, aligned with ETR). However, WP-specific meetings will be organised by WP leaders to make sure the work advances as proposed (minimum quarterly or with more frequency depending on specific needs). An Advisory Board comprising 2 academic and 2 non-academic experts, will be set up by M6 to make sure that broader scientific and stakeholder perspectives are considered to the best extent possible in EMPOWERALL's activities. Representatives of the AEP, eLTER RI, EU policy networks, as well as coordinators or relevant partners of synergic AEP sister projects and Soil Mission and Horizon projects, will be invited to attend the consortium meetings or participate in online events (e.g., webinars, training sessions), in order to ensure scientific coordination with the broader community and to allow the AEP to assess progresses made and how EMPOWERALL fits in its broader project landscape. Finally, consortium partners will dedicate time and resources to nurture feedback loops with the AEP by allocating part of the budget to participate in the three planned dissemination meetings (kick-off, mid-term and end-term). **Task 6.2: Administrative management, gender and ethics (M1-M36), lead: CSIC, contributors: NIBIO, CEBC, LOBA, UPCO, UB, SCDA, ILE**					

This task will deal with all contractual and other legal issues related to the project. In particular, it will comprise Grant Agreement (GA) and Consortium Agreement (CA, based on the DESCA model, if mandatory for any partner) implementation and amendments, and the related procedures. This task also deals with all reporting requirements of the project, progress, MTR and ETR reports, according to the instructions established by the AEP. The R+I purpose of EMPOWERALL does not include an explicit investigation or evaluation of the gender dimension in its objectives or work plan. However, consortium partners will proactively listen to signals that would require/justify the inclusion of a gender perspective and recognise the role of women in rural communities and agroecological reproductive activities, and will be ready to expand the reach of activities if/where needed (following the EU regulation 1291/2013). Furthermore, local events will carry out at least one activity (e.g., presentation) to raise awareness on gender equality and unconscious gender biases on assessing/promoting the role of women in rural communities. Finally, CSIC will develop guidelines on 'Ethics and data protection' expanding on the Data Management Plan (DMP), which will be reviewed during the MTR to produce a consolidated report based on lessons learnt during the first half of the project (D6.2, M23).	
Deliverables	D6.1 – Project Management Manual (M6) – Lead: CSIC D6.2 – Revised Data Management Plan based on lessons learnt (M23) – Lead: CSIC
Milestones	MS6.1 – Second Consortium Meeting in Romania (M18) – Lead: UB MS6.2 – Third Consortium Meeting in France (M18) – Lead: CEBC
Risk and mitigation of risks	Risk 6.1 – Partner activities are not aligned and do not meet project objectives. Mitigation measure: regular WP and Steering Committee meetings will ensure activities are streamlined, and lessons learnt are shared. Amendments will be considered to adapt strategies Risk 6.2 – Slow progress of the project resulting in poor delivery and project outcomes. Mitigation measures: several milestones have been foreseen that will allow precise monitoring of the state-of-play of the activities and ensuring participatory activities run smoothly

	M1	M2	M3	M4	M5	M6	M7	M8	M9	M10	M11	M12	M13	M14	M15	M16	M17	M18	M19	M20	M21	M22	M23	M24	M25	M26	M27	M28	M29	M30	M31	M32	M33	M34	M35	M36
WP1 - Youth-driven AELLs definition, mapping and engagement within LTSER Platforms																																				
T1.1				MS1.1					D1.1																											
T1.2								MS1.2				D1.2																								
T1.3												MS1.3																								
WP2 - Systemic methodological framework and initial diagnosis of current situation of AELLs																																				
T2.1						MS2.1				D2.1		MS2.2																								
T2.2															D2.2																					
T2.3															MS2.3		MS2.4	D2.3																		
WP3 - System analysis and dynamics for youth-led agroecological innovations																																				
T3.1																		MS3.1			MS3.2															
T3.2																							MS3.3	D3.1												
T3.3																										MS3.4	D3.2									
WP4 - AELLs-LTSER network interactions to inform youth-led agroecological transition and policy impact pathways																																				
T4.1																		D4.1																D4.2		
T4.2																											MS4.1		MS4.2					D4.3		
T4.3																																				D4.4
WP5 - Dissemination, Exploitation and Communication																																				
T5.1				D5.1														D5.2																		D5.3
T5.2					MS5.1																															
T5.3						MS5.2																														
WP6 - Project coordination and management																																				
T6.1						D6.1												MS6.1																MS6.2		
T6.2																							D6.2													

The objective of the Dissemination, Exploitation, and Communication (DEC) Plan is to ensure that the results of the EMPOWERALL project reach relevant stakeholders effectively, with maximum impact on agroecology policies, youth-led initiatives, and sustainable farming practices. Therefore, the decision was made to have WP5 fully dedicated to such activity. Designing DEC requires a strategy that is multi-faceted and that caters to main target audiences that can act as a window into the project's activities to show the human face of the project in line with agroecological principles.

The overall goals of the DEC involve establishing a strong visual identity, creating engaging practice-based storytelling methods, such as videos, infographics, factsheets, articles and campaigns, that include an emphasis on human experience and appeal to a wide audience, providing a voice to the rural youth and starting a wider conversation on the positive impacts of agroecology in the context of degrading soil and farming systems. EMPOWERALL's visual identity will be applied across communication channels related to the project and will include templates for material such as reports, presentations, factsheets and press releases, which can also be translated into the native languages of project partners and target audiences when necessary.

The project's website will serve as a central communications hub that will act both as a dissemination tool and a repository for outputs, publications, project results, validated outcomes and solutions. It will also feature dedicated sections to publicise information about summits, internal and external events, news updates (including a quarterly newsletter and articles), publications, policy tools and press material. As a repository, the website will provide access to actionable knowledge from the WPs, peer-reviewed scientific articles as well as non-technical publications. The website will cater to a wide audience, ranging from project partners to end-users, policymakers and journalists. Social media will also be central to DEC activity, with, for example a LinkedIn page that will gather and publish information relating to the AELLs activities and findings as well as material of a broader interest within the field of agroecology. Videos will be an important communication tool in EMPOWERALL, for example introduce each AELLs and its LTSER Platforms or to showcase the 'behind-the-scenes' activities or best practices they have tested. These can be hosted in repositories of practical information that will be of interest to other farmers active in similar regions.

Also, a number of public events will be taken during the project to raise societal awareness about the presence, function and impact of the AELLs (e.g., field visits, public talks). A strategy to raise awareness among a wider audience beyond the geographical areas of the AELLs and LTSER Platforms Hubs will run parallel with informative material designed to catch the attention of the media. Peer-reviewed scientific publications relating to project findings will be made available via Green Open Access (GOA). Such publications will also be well disseminated through the project websites and other websites linked to the partners' activities. In order to make the project's validated solutions understandable and accessible to decision-makers as well as farmers, the project plans to create information sheets linking agroecological innovations and practices to potential policies.

Activities and results of the project will also be broadcast in a variety of pre-existing channels to reach the maximum audience (e.g., specific messages will be launched toward synergic projects, connections will be established with relevant initiatives and networks, partners will make evident their involvement in EMPOWERALL in a number of conferences and meetings. Towards the end of the project, public authorities/rural development agencies of regions near the area covered by EMPOWERALL will be engaged to have local policy makers (as well as scientists and change makers) to understand the potential benefits of the AELLs approach linked to LTSER Platforms. Finally, it will be important to unleash full cooperation by reassuring participants that their contribution and previous knowledge is valued. For this reason, the Consortium Agreement will already define the IPRs of each partner with respect to the foreground developed in the project, and IP management guidelines will be included in such a multilateral contract.

In the EMPOWERALL context, data serves as the foundation for generating actionable knowledge, particularly in the context of the AELLs linked to the LTSER Platforms. On the one hand, the project will leverage data from the LTSER Platforms and transform them into knowledge that can inform innovative, user-centred processes in the AELLs. On the other hand, the project will gather newly generated data through different social-research methods (e.g., interviews, questionnaires and participant observation in focus groups and workshops), that will be used to enhance LTSER Platform performance. One of the core principles of GOV4ALL is ensuring that both types of data are accessible and reusable. The project will therefore employ EU open science platforms to make all data widely available. Effective data management will be a cornerstone of EMPOWERALL's repositories, ensuring that both scientific and knowledge data are stored, accessed, and utilized securely and efficiently. All planned activities within EMPOWERALL project will fully comply with guidelines for Ethics and Research Integrity that will be established in the Grant Agreement. A specific article will require that all actions align with ethical standards and relevant EU, international, and national laws, as well as the EU Charter of Fundamental Rights and the European Convention for the Protection of Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms, along with its Supplementary Protocols. It will underscores the need to respect the principle of proportionality, ensure privacy and protection of personal data, safeguard physical and mental integrity, prevent discrimination, and guarantee environmental protection and high standards of human health protection. All tasks within the EMPOWERALL will be designed to meet these legal and regulatory requirements. The project management team will ensure that proper procedures are followed, particularly in securing, collecting, and maintaining consent forms from participants before data collection begins, as required. The initial set of principles will reflect on the following guidelines:

1. Data Description and Collection:

1.1. What data will be collected or created? For example: survey data, interview transcripts, observational notes, social media data, administrative records, audio/video recordings).

1.2. How will the data be collected? For example: surveys, interviews, focus groups, experiments, ethnography, secondary data analysis.

1.3. Data volume and formats: Estimation of the amount of data and specification of the file formats (e.g., CSV, TXT, SPSS, STATA, XML, JSON, audio/video formats). Prioritize open and non-proprietary formats for long-term accessibility.

1.4. Existing data: If using existing datasets, explanation of their source, any limitations, and how they will be integrated.

2. Documentation and Metadata: identification of the metadata standards that will be used to describe the data (e.g., DDI for quantitative social science data, Dublin Core).

3. Ethical and Legal Considerations:

3.1. Informed consent: Explanation of how informed consent will be obtained from participants, specifically addressing data storage, sharing, and potential future use. This is particularly crucial for sensitive data.

3.2. Anonymization/Pseudonymization: Detail of the strategies for protecting participant privacy, including techniques for anonymizing or pseudonymizing data to prevent re-identification.

3.3. Data protection regulations (e.g., GDPR): Outlining of how the plan complies with relevant data protection laws and institutional policies.

3.4. Confidentiality: Description of measures to maintain confidentiality of sensitive data.

3.5. Access control: Specification of who will have access to the data during the project and under what conditions.

This principles will be fully developed in the Grant Agreement and the initial version of the project's DMP, and best practices and lessons learned from the AELLs will be documented and shared through D6.2 in M23.